“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 17

The Journey to Śrī Vṛndāvana

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. That year, after seeing the Ratha-yātrā in Śrī Kṣetra, Mahāprabhu firmly resolved to go to Vṛndāvana. Śrī Rāmānanda and Śrī Svarūpa gave Him Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya as a companion, together with a brāhmaṇa (a servant) who accompanied him. Before daybreak the Lord set out toward Kaṭaka; then, keeping Kaṭaka on His right, He went on by lonely forest paths. On that forest road, full of love, He made tigers, elephants and other animals sing the name of Kṛṣṇa. Wherever they found a village, they begged alms there and cooked rice, vegetables and so on. Where there were no villages (no people), they cooked the rice they had stored and gathered wild greens and the like. The Lord was very pleased with Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya's care. Travelling thus by the forest paths of Jhārikhaṇḍa, the Lord arrived in Vārāṇasī-dhāma. As He was bathing at the Maṇikarṇikā *ghāṭa*, Tapana Miśra met Him. Tapana Miśra took the Lord to his home and lodged Him there with great care. In Vārāṇasī the Lord was also served by His devotee of long standing, Candraśekhara Vaidya (who was now living there). A brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra saw how the Lord conducted Himself and told Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, the chief of the *sannyāsīs*, about it, and Prakāśānanda spoke much against the Lord. The brāhmaṇa was pained by this. He came to the Lord, told Him what had been said, and asked why the name of Kṛṣṇa did not come to the lips of Prakāśānanda and the other *sannyāsīs*. In reply the Lord ruled that Māyāvāda is an offence (*aparādha*), forbade association with Māyāvādīs, and so showed the brāhmaṇa His mercy. (Then the Lord) went from Kāśī by way of Prayāga to Mathurā. There He blessed a Sanoḍiyā brāhmaṇa, a disciple of Śrī

Mādhavendra Purī, and accepted a meal in his home. Afterwards, in great love, the Lord began to wander through the twelve forests of Śrī Vṛndāvana, listening to the conversation of Śārī and Śuka.

On the way to Vṛndāvana, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya gives love for Kṛṣṇa to beasts and birds —

গচ্ছন্ বৃন্দাবনং গৌরো
ব্যাঘ্রেভৈণখগান্ বনে ৷
প্রেমোন্মত্তান্ সহোন্নৃত্যান্
বিদধে কৃষ্ণজল্পিনঃ ॥ ১ ॥

gacchan vṛndāvanaṁ gauro
going to Vṛndāvana Gaura
vyāghrebhaiṇa-khagān vane
tigers, elephants, deer and birds in the forest
premonmattān sahonnṛtyān
maddened with love dancing along with Him
vidadhe kṛṣṇa-jalpinaḥ
made chanting "Kṛṣṇa"

1 As Gaura went to Vṛndāvana, He made the tigers, elephants, deer and birds of the forest mad with love: they danced along with Him and chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

On His way to Vṛndāvana, in the forest (along His road), Śrī Gauracandra made the tigers, elephants, deer and birds repeat the name of Kṛṣṇa, maddened them with love, and made them dance.

Anubhāṣya.

gauraḥ vṛndāvanaṁ gacchan (having set out to go) **vane** (on the forest path through Jhārikhaṇḍa) **vyāghrebhaiṇa-khagān** (tigers, elephants, deer, birds and others) **premonmattān** (absorbed in love for Kṛṣṇa) **sahonnṛtyān** (dancing wildly together with Gaura) **kṛṣṇa-jalpinaḥ** (calling out "Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa") **vidadhe** (made them).

জয় জয় গৌরচন্দ্র জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya gauracandra jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Gauracandra glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

In autumn the Lord wishes to set out and confers with Svarūpa and Rāya —

শরৎকাল হৈল, প্রভুর চলিতে হৈল মতি ।
রামানন্দ-স্বরূপ-সঙ্গে নিভৃতে যুকতি ॥ ৩ ॥

śarat-kāla haila, prabhura calite haila mati
autumn came the Lord's to set out arose the intention
rāmānanda-svarūpa-saṅge nibhṛte yukati
with Rāmānanda and Svarūpa in private consultation

3 When autumn came, the Lord resolved to set out, and He took counsel in private with Rāmānanda and Svarūpa.

মোর সহায় কর যদি, তুমি-দুই জন ।
তবে আমি যাঞা দেখি শ্রীবৃন্দাবন ॥ ৪ ॥

mora sahāya kara yadi, tumi-dui jana
to Me help you give if you two persons
tabe āmi yāñā dekhi śrī-vṛndāvana
then I going may see Śrī Vṛndāvana

4 "If you two will help Me, then I can go and see Śrī Vṛndāvana.

The Lord wishes to go without taking a second companion —

রাত্রে উঠি’ বনপথে পলাঞা যাব ৷
একাকী যাইব, কাঁহো সঙ্গে না লইব ॥ ৫ ॥

rātre uṭhi’ vana-pathe palāñā yāba
at night rising by the forest path slipping away I shall go
ekākī yāiba, kāṁho saṅge nā laiba
alone I shall go anyone with Me not I shall take

5 I shall rise at night and slip away by the forest path. I shall go alone and take no one with Me.

কেহ যদি সঙ্গ লইতে পাছে উঠি’ ধায় ৷
সবারে রাখিবা, যেন কেহ নাহি যায় ॥ ৬ ॥

keha yadi saṅga laite pāche uṭhi’ dhāya
anyone if company to keep after Me rising runs
sabāre rākhibā, yena keha nāhi yāya
all you will hold back so that anyone not goes

6 If anyone gets up and runs after Me to keep Me company, hold them all back, so that no one follows.

The Lord asks His devotees for their goodwill —

প্রসন্ন হঞা আজ্ঞা দিবা, না মানিবা ‘দুঃখ’ ৷
তোমা-সবার ‘সুখে’ পথে হবে মোর ‘সুখ’ ॥ ৭ ॥

prasanna haña ājñā dibā, nā mānibā ‘duḥkha’
pleased being leave give not consider it a sorrow
tomā-sabāra ‘sukhe’ pathe habe mora ‘sukha’
of you all in the happiness on the road will be My happiness

7 Give Me leave gladly, and do not take it as a sorrow. If you are all happy, I shall be happy on the road.”

The request of Svarūpa and Rāya to the Lord —

দুইজন কহে, — তুমি ঈশ্বর ‘স্বতন্ত্র’ ।
যেই ইচ্ছা, সেই করিবা, নহ ‘পরতন্ত্র’ ॥ ৮ ॥

dui-jana kahe, — tumi īśvara ‘svatantra’
the two say — You the Lord independent
yei icchā, sei karibā, naha ‘paratantra’
whatever You wish that You will do You are not dependent

8 The two of them said, “You are the independent Lord. Whatever You wish, You will do; You depend on no one.

The Lord's pleasure lies in His devotee's happiness —

কিন্তু আমা-দুঁহার শুন এক নিবেদনে ।
তোমার সুখে আমার সুখ — কহিলা আপনে ॥ ৯ ॥

kintu āmā-duṁhāra śuna eka nivedane
but of us two hear one request
tomāra sukhe āmāra sukha — kahilā āpane
in your happiness My happiness — You said Yourself

9 But hear one request from the two of us. You Yourself have said, ‘In your happiness is My happiness.’

The devotee's happiness lies in the Lord's pleasure —

আমা-দুঁহার মনে তবে বড় ‘সুখ’ হয় ।
এক নিবেদন যদি ধর, দয়াময় ॥ ১০ ॥

āmā-duṁhāra mane tabe baḍa ‘sukha’ haya
of us two in the mind then great happiness will be
eka nivedana yadi dhara, dayāmaya
one request if You accept O merciful one

10 Our hearts will be very happy, O merciful Lord, if You grant us one request.

A request to take one Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇa along —

‘উত্তম ব্রাহ্মণ’ এক সঙ্গে অবশ্য চাহি ।
ভিক্ষা করি’ ভিক্ষা দিবে, যাবে পাত্র বহি’ ॥ ১১ ॥

‘uttama brāhmaṇa’ eka saṅge avaśya cāhi
a worthy brāhmaṇa one with You certainly we want
bhikṣā kari’ bhikṣā dibe, yābe pātra vahi’
alms collecting meals he will give he will go the waterpot carrying

11 We must ask that one good brāhmaṇa go with You. He will collect alms and give You Your meals, and he will carry Your waterpot.

বনপথে যাইতে নাহি ‘ভোজ্যান্ন’ ব্রাহ্মণ ।
আজ্ঞা কর, — সঙ্গে চলুক বিপ্র একজন ॥ ১২ ॥

vana-pathe yāite nāhi ‘bhojyānna’ brāhmaṇa
on the forest path going there is no whose food may be accepted brāhmaṇa
ājñā kara, — saṅge caluka vipra eka-jana
give the order — with You let go a brāhmaṇa one

12 On the forest path there is no brāhmaṇa whose food You could accept. Permit one brāhmaṇa to go with You.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“A *bhojyānna* brāhmaṇa” means a brāhmaṇa whose food may be eaten, that is, one from whom it is not wrong to accept food.

The Lord does not wish to take anyone and describes the kind of companion He would accept —

প্রভু কহে, — নিজ-সঙ্গী কাঁহো না লইব ।
একজনে নিলে, আনের মনে দুঃখ হইব ॥ ১৩ ॥

prabhu kahe, — nija-saṅgī kāṁho nā laiba
the Lord says — of My own companions anyone not I shall take
eka-jane nile, ānera mane duḥkha haiba
one person if I take of the others in the mind sorrow will be

13 The Lord said, “I shall not take any of My own companions. If I take one, the others will be unhappy.

নূতন সঙ্গী হইবেক, — স্নিগ্ধ যাঁর মন ।
ঐছে যবে পাই, তবে লই ‘এক’ জন ॥ ১৪ ॥

nūtana saṅgī haibeka, — snigdha yāṁra mana
new the companion should be — loving whose mind
aiche yabe pāi, tabe lai ‘eka’ jana
such when I find then I take one person

14 Let My companion be someone new, whose heart is full of love. If I find such a person, I will take that one alone.”[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“There is no need for Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa and others to come with Me as before; but I may take some new companion whose heart is loving.”

Svarūpa chooses Balabhadra Bhaṭṭa and one companion of his, a brāhmaṇa servant, and asks the Lord to take them along —

স্বরূপ কহে, — এই বলভদ্র-ভট্টাচার্য্য ।
তোমাতে সুস্নিগ্ধ বড়, পণ্ডিত, সাধু, আর্য্য ॥ ১৫ ॥

svarūpa kahe, — ei balabhadra-bhaṭṭācārya
Svarūpa says — here is Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya
tomāte su-snigdha baḍa, paṇḍita, sādhu, ārya
toward You affectionate very learned saintly noble

15 Svarūpa said, “Here is Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya. He is full of love for You, and he is learned, saintly and noble.

Anubhāṣya.
Snigdha. In the verse “…the gurus reveal even what is secret to a loving (*snigdhasya*) disciple” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.1.8), Śrīdhara Svāmipāda explains the word *snigdhasya* as *premavataḥ*, “to one who has love.”

*A simple brāhmaṇa, in whom the inclination to pious works (*karma*) is still strong, is given the chance to purify himself in the Lord's company —*

প্রথমেই তোমা-সঙ্গে আইলা গৌড় হৈতে ।
ইঁহার ইচ্ছা আছে 'সর্ব্বতীর্থ' করিতে ॥ ১৬ ॥

prathamei tomā-saṅge āilā gauḍa haite
at the very first with You he came Gauḍa from
iṁhāra icchā āche 'sarva-tīrtha' karite
his desire is all the holy places to visit

16 He came with You from Gauḍa at the very start, and he wishes to visit all the holy places.

The duties of Balabhadra and of the brāhmaṇa who accompanies him —

ইঁহার সঙ্গে আছে বিপ্র এক 'ভৃত্য' ।
ইঁহো পথে করিবেন সেবাভিক্ষা-কৃত্য ॥ ১৭ ॥

iṁhāra saṅge āche vipra eka 'bhṛtya'
with him together there is a brāhmaṇa one servant
iṁho pathe karibena sevābhikṣā-kṛtya
he on the road will perform the duties of service and meals

17 With him is a brāhmaṇa servant, and on the road the Bhaṭṭācārya himself will serve You and see to Your meals.

ইঁহারে সঙ্গে লহ যদি, সবার হয় 'সুখ' ।
বন-পথে যাইতে তোমার নহিবে কোন 'দুঃখ' ॥ ১৮ ॥

iṁhāre saṅge laha yadi, sabāra haya 'sukha'
him with You You take if of everyone is happiness
vana-pathe yāite tomāra nahibe kona 'duḥkha'
on the forest path going Your will not be any hardship

18 If You take him with You, everyone will be happy, and You will meet no hardship on the forest path.

সেই বিপ্র বহি' নিবে বস্ত্রাম্বুভাজন ।
ভট্টাচার্য্য ভিক্ষা দিবে করি' ভিক্ষাটন ॥ ১৯ ॥

sei vipra vahi' nibe vastrāmbu-bhājana
that brāhmaṇa carrying will take the cloth and the waterpot
bhaṭṭācārya bhikṣā dibe kari' bhikṣāṭana
the Bhaṭṭācārya meals will give doing the rounds for alms

19 That brāhmaṇa will carry Your cloth and waterpot, and the Bhaṭṭācārya will go begging alms and give You Your meals."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vastrāmbu-bhājana means His cloth and water pot.

The Lord agrees —

তাঁহার বচন প্রভু অঙ্গীকার কৈল ।
বলভদ্র-ভট্টাচার্য্যে সঙ্গে করি' নিল ॥ ২০ ॥

tāṁhāra vacana prabhu aṅgīkāra kaila
his words the Lord acceptance made
balabhadra-bhaṭṭācārye saṅge kari' nila
Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya as a companion making took

20 The Lord accepted Svarūpa's words and took Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya with Him.

At night the Lord takes Jagannātha's leave, and at the end of the night He secretly departs for Vṛndāvana —

পূর্ব্বরাত্রে জগন্নাথ দেখি' 'আজ্ঞা' লঞা ।
শেষ-রাত্রে উঠি' প্রভু চলিলা লুকাঞা ॥ ২১ ॥

pūrva-rātre jagannātha dekhi' 'ājñā' lañā
the night before Jagannātha seeing permission taking
śeṣa-rātre uṭhi' prabhu calilā lukāñā
at the end of the night rising the Lord set out in secret

21 The night before, He saw Jagannātha and received His permission. Then, rising at the end of the night, the Lord set out in secret.

In the morning the devotees, distraught in separation, search for the Lord —

প্রাতঃকালে ভক্তগণ প্রভু না দেখিয়া ।
অন্বেষণ করি' ফিরে ব্যাকুল হঞা ॥ ২২ ॥

prātaḥ-kāle bhakta-gaṇa prabhu nā dekhiyā
in the morning the devotees the Lord not seeing
anveṣaṇa kari' phire vyākula hañā
search making wander about distressed becoming

22 In the morning the devotees could not find the Lord, and they went about searching for Him in distress.

Svarūpa restrains the devotees, and they give up the search —

স্বরূপ-গোসাঞি সবায় কৈল নিবারণ ।
নিবৃত্ত হঞা রহে সবে, জানি' প্রভুর মন ॥ ২৩ ॥

svarūpa-gosāñi sabāya kaila nivāraṇa
Svarūpa Gosāñi everyone made restraint
nivṛtta hañā rahe sabe, jāni' prabhura mana
desisting becoming remain all knowing the Lord's mind

23 Svarūpa Gosāñi held them all back, and knowing the Lord's mind, they all gave up the search.

How the Lord travelled by the forest road; by His mercy even beasts and birds are delivered and attain love for Kṛṣṇa —

প্রসিদ্ধ পথ ছাড়ি' প্রভু উপপথে চলিলা ।
'কটক' ডাহিনে করি' বনে প্রবেশিলা ॥ ২৪ ॥

prasiddha patha chāḍi' prabhu upapathe calilā
the well-known road leaving the Lord by a side path went
'kaṭaka' ḍāhine kari' vane praveśilā
Kaṭaka on the right keeping into the forest He entered

24 Leaving the main road, the Lord went by a side path. Keeping Kaṭaka on His right, He entered the forest.

নির্জ্জন-বনে চলে প্রভু কৃষ্ণনাম লঞা ।
হস্তী-ব্যাঘ্র পথ ছাড়ে প্রভুরে দেখিয়া ॥ ২৫ ॥

nirjana-vane cale prabhu kṛṣṇa-nāma lañā
through the lonely forest goes the Lord Kṛṣṇa's name taking
hastī-vyāghra patha chāḍe prabhure dekhiyā
elephants and tigers the path leave the Lord seeing

25 The Lord went through the lonely forest chanting Kṛṣṇa's name, and elephants and tigers left the path when they saw Him.

পালে-পালে ব্যাঘ্র, হস্তী, গণ্ডার, শূকরগণ ।
তার মধ্যে আবেশে প্রভু করিলা গমন ॥ ২৬ ॥

pāle-pāle vyāghra, hastī, gaṇḍāra, śūkara-gaṇa
herd upon herd tigers elephants rhinoceroses boars
tāra madhye āveśe prabhu karilā gamana
of them in the midst in ecstasy the Lord made His way

26 There were herds of tigers, elephants, rhinoceroses and boars, and the Lord, absorbed in ecstasy, made His way through their midst.

দেখি' ভট্টাচার্য্যের মনে হয় মহাভয় ।
প্রভুর প্রতাপে তারা এক পাশ হয় ॥ ২৭ ॥

dekhi' bhaṭṭācāryera mane haya mahā-bhaya
seeing in the Bhaṭṭācārya's mind arises great fear
prabhura pratāpe tārā eka pāśa haya
by the Lord's power they to one side move

27 Seeing this, the Bhaṭṭācārya was terrified, but by the Lord's power the animals stood aside.

একদিন পথে ব্যাঘ্র করিয়াছে শয়ন ।
আবেশে তার গায়ে প্রভুর লাগিল চরণ ॥ ২৮ ॥

ekadina pathe vyāghra kariyāche śayana
one day on the path a tiger had made lying down
āveśe tāra gāye prabhura lāgila caraṇa
in ecstasy its against the body the Lord's touched foot

28 One day a tiger was lying on the path, and the Lord, lost in ecstasy, touched its body with His foot.

প্রভু কহে, — কহ 'কৃষ্ণ', ব্যাঘ্র উঠিল ।
'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' কহি' ব্যাঘ্র নাচিতে লাগিল ॥ ২৯ ॥

prabhu kahe, — kaha 'kṛṣṇa', vyāghra uṭhila
the Lord says — say "Kṛṣṇa" the tiger rose
'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' kahi' vyāghra nācite lāgila
Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa saying the tiger to dance began

29 The Lord said, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa'!" The tiger rose and began to dance, saying, "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!"

আর দিনে মহাপ্রভু করে নদীস্নান ।
মত্তহস্তীযূথ আইল করিতে জলপান ॥ ৩০ ॥

āra dine mahāprabhu kare nadī-snāna
on another day Mahāprabhu takes a bath in the river
matta-hastī-yūtha āila karite jala-pāna
a herd of maddened elephants came to do drinking of water

30 On another day, while Mahāprabhu was bathing in a river, a herd of maddened elephants came to drink.

প্রভু জলে কৃত্য করেন, আগে হস্তী আইলা ।
'কৃষ্ণ কহ' বলি' প্রভু জল ফেলি' মারিলা ॥ ৩১ ॥

prabhu jale kṛtya karena, āge hastī āilā
the Lord in the water His rites performs before Him the elephants came
'kṛṣṇa kaha' bali' prabhu jala pheli' mārilā
"Kṛṣṇa say" saying the Lord water throwing splashed

31 As the Lord performed His rites in the water, the elephants came before Him. Crying, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa'!", the Lord splashed water at them.

Anubhāṣya.

A *mahā-bhāgavata* has realized nondual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*). So he has no absorption in a "second," nor the fear and hostility born of it. He also abides constantly in worshipping Kṛṣṇa, the Lord he serves. Therefore everywhere he sees Kṛṣṇa and those who belong to Kṛṣṇa (*kārṣṇa*), that is, his own kin. As a result, all other beings related to Kṛṣṇa also regard him as worthy of love, as one of their own. So there is no room between them for want of love or for hostility. On the path through Jhārikhaṇḍa, too, the Lord was always seen to show what befits a *mahā-bhāgavata*: the endeavour to search for Kṛṣṇa in Vraja.

Kṛtya means bathing, chanting a mantra, remembrance and the like.

সেই-জল-বিন্দু-কণা লাগে যাঁর গায় ।
সেই 'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' কহে, প্রেমে নাচে, গায় ॥ ৩২ ॥

sei-jala-bindu-kaṇā lāge yāṁra gāya
of that water drops sprays touch whose body
sei 'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' kahe, preme nāce, gāya
he Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa says in love dances sings

32 Every elephant those drops of water touched cried, "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!" and danced and sang in love.

কেহ ভূমে পড়ে, কেহ করয়ে চিৎকার ।
দেখি' ভট্টাচার্য্যের মনে হয় চমৎকার ॥ ৩৩ ॥

keha bhūme paḍe, keha karaye citkāra
some on the ground fall some make loud cries
dekhi' bhaṭṭācāryera mane haya camatkāra
seeing in the Bhaṭṭācārya's mind arises wonder

33 Some fell to the ground, and some trumpeted loudly. Seeing this, the Bhaṭṭācārya was struck with wonder.

পথে যাইতে করে প্রভু উচ্চ-সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ।
মধুর কণ্ঠধ্বনি শুনি' আইসে মৃগীগণ ॥ ৩৪ ॥

pathe yāite kare prabhu ucca-saṅkīrtana
on the road going does the Lord loud saṅkīrtana
madhura kaṇṭha-dhvani śuni' āise mṛgī-gaṇa
sweet the sound of His voice hearing come the does

34 As He went along the road, the Lord would sing the holy name aloud, and hearing His sweet voice, the does came to Him.

ডাহিনে-বামে ধ্বনি শুনি' যায় প্রভু-সঙ্গে ।
প্রভু তার অঙ্গ মুছে, শ্লোক পড়ে রঙ্গে ॥ ৩৫ ॥

ḍāhine-vāme dhvani śuni' yāya prabhu-saṅge
right and left the sound hearing go with the Lord
prabhu tāra aṅga muche, śloka paḍe raṅge
the Lord their bodies strokes a verse recites joyfully

35 Listening to the sound, they walked with the Lord on His right and left. The Lord stroked them and joyfully recited a verse:

ধন্যাঃ স্ম মূঢ়মতয়োঽপি হরিণ্য এতা
যা নন্দনন্দনমুপাত্ত-বিচিত্রবেশম্ ।
আকর্ণ্য বেণুরণিতং সহকৃষ্ণসারাঃ
পূজাং দধুর্বিরচিতাং প্রণয়াবলোকৈঃ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

dhanyāḥ sma mūḍha-matayo 'pi hariṇya etā
blessed indeed foolish-minded though does these
yā nanda-nandanam upātta-vicitraveśam
who to the son of Nanda who had put on wondrous attire
ākarṇya veṇu-raṇitaṁ saha-kṛṣṇa-sārāḥ
hearing the sound of the flute together with the black bucks
pūjāṁ dadhur viracitāṁ praṇayāvalokaiḥ
worship offered arranged with loving glances

36 "How blessed are these does! Foolish though they are, on hearing the flute, they and their mates, the black bucks, have worshipped the wondrously attired son of Nanda with their loving glances." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Blessed are these simple-minded does: they found the son of Nanda in His wonderful attire and heard the sound of His flute, and together with the black bucks (*kṛṣṇa-sāras*) they worshipped Him with glances full of love.

Anubhāṣya.

When autumn came, Kṛṣṇa began to wander from forest to forest, playing His flute. Hearing the sound of His flute, the gopīs, longing for Kṛṣṇa's company, sang:

"O friend, **mūḍha-matayaḥ** (whose minds are foolish, without discrimination) **api** (though born as animals) **etāḥ hariṇyaḥ** (these does) **dhanyāḥ** (have attained the goal of life) **sma**, for **yāḥ** (these does) **veṇu-raṇitam** (the sound of the flute) **ākarṇya** (having heard) **saha-kṛṣṇa-sārāḥ** (together with the black bucks, their husbands) **upātta-vicitra-veśam** (to Him who has put on wonderful attire—a garland of forest flowers, a crown of peacock feathers, earrings of *guñjā* berries and so on) **nanda-nandanam** (to the son of Nanda) **praṇayāvalokaiḥ** (with glances full of love) **viracitām** (adorned) **pūjām** (worship) **dadhuḥ** (offered)."

হেনকালে ব্যাঘ্র তথা আইল পাঁচ-সাত ।
ব্যাঘ্র-মৃগী মিলি' চলে মহাপ্রভুর সাথ ॥ ৩৭ ॥

hena-kāle vyāghra tathā āila pāṁca-sāta
at that time tigers there came five or seven
vyāghra-mṛgī mili' cale mahāprabhura sātha
tigers and does together go Mahāprabhu's company

37 Just then five or seven tigers came there, and the tigers and does walked together with Mahāprabhu.

দেখি' মহাপ্রভুর 'বৃন্দাবন'-স্মৃতি হৈল ।
বৃন্দাবন-গুণ-বর্ণন শ্লোক পড়িল ॥ ৩৮ ॥

dekhi' mahāprabhura 'vṛndāvana'-smṛti haila
seeing in Mahāprabhu of Vṛndāvana remembrance arose
vṛndāvana-guṇa-varṇana śloka paḍila
Vṛndāvana's qualities describing a verse He recited

38 Seeing this, Mahāprabhu remembered Vṛndāvana, and He recited a verse describing its glories:

In Vṛndāvana there is no feeling opposed to nondual Knowledge —

যত্র নৈসর্গদুর্ব্বৈরাঃ সহাসন্ নৃ-মৃগাদয়ঃ ।
মিত্রাণীবাজিতাবাস-দ্রুত-রুট্‌তর্ষণাদিকম্ ॥ ৩৯ ॥

yatra naisarga-durvairāḥ
where by nature bitter enemies
sahāsan nṛ-mṛgādayaḥ
lived together men, beasts and others
mitrāṇīvājitāvāsa-
like friends the abode of the Unconquered
druta-ruṭ-tarṣaṇādikam
fled away anger, thirst and the like

39 "There, in the abode of the Unconquerable Lord, men and beasts, enemies by nature, lived together like friends, and anger, thirst and the like had fled away." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.13.60)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

There men, tigers and others, though by nature hostile to one another, live together as friends. Anger, thirst and the like have abandoned that abode and fled, because it is the place of Kṛṣṇa's delight (His eternal pastimes). (It was this transcendental abode of Vṛndāvana that Brahmā beheld.)

Anubhāṣya.

Brahmā stole the calves and cowherd boys of Vraja. After a moment (*truṭi*) he again saw, in that same Vraja, calves and cowherd boys endowed with supreme majesty, playing with Kṛṣṇa, and he was utterly bewildered by Kṛṣṇa's *māyā*. Then Kṛṣṇa mercifully lifted the curtain of His *māyā*. Brahmā looked around like one awakened from sleep and beheld Śrī Vṛndāvana, full of the greatest splendour:

yatra naisarga-durvairāḥ (though by nature bearing an enmity that cannot be removed) **nṛ-mṛgādayaḥ** (men, lions and others) **mitrāṇi iva** (like friends) **saha āsan** (lived together); (such a Vṛndāvana) **ajitāvāsa-druta-ruṭ-tarṣaṇādikam** (the dwelling of Ajita, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the place where He always abides, from which anger, greed, thirst and the like have swiftly fled before its own glory)—"he saw Vṛndāvana": so it connects with the preceding verse.

'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' কহ করি' প্রভু যবে বলিল ।
'কৃষ্ণ' কহি' ব্যাঘ্র-মৃগ নাচিতে লাগিল ॥ ৪০ ॥

'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' kaha kari' prabhu yabe balila
Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa say thus the Lord when said
'kṛṣṇa' kahi' vyāghra-mṛga nācite lāgila
Kṛṣṇa saying the tigers and deer to dance began

40 When the Lord said, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!'" the tigers and deer began to dance, saying, "Kṛṣṇa!"

নাচে, কান্দে ব্যাঘ্রগণ মৃগীগণ-সঙ্গে ।
বলভদ্র-ভট্টাচার্য্য দেখে অপূর্ব্ব-রঙ্গে ॥ ৪১ ॥

nāce, kānde vyāghra-gaṇa mṛgī-gaṇa-saṅge
dance weep the tigers together with the does
balabhadra-bhaṭṭācārya dekhe apūrva-raṅge
Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya watches with wonder at the unprecedented sport

41 The tigers danced and wept together with the does, and Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya watched, amazed at this wondrous play.

ব্যাঘ্র-মৃগ অন্যোন্যে করে আলিঙ্গন ।
মুখে মুখ দিয়া করে অন্যোন্যে চুম্বন ॥ ৪২ ॥

vyāghra-mṛga anyonye kare āliṅgana
tigers and deer one another do embracing
mukhe mukha diyā kare anyonye cumbana
to mouth mouth putting do one another kissing

42 The tigers and deer embraced one another, and putting mouth to mouth, they kissed.

কৌতুক দেখিয়া প্রভু হাসিতে লাগিলা ।
তা-সবাকে তাঁহা ছাড়ি' আগে চলি' গেলা ॥ ৪৩ ॥

kautuka dekhiyā prabhu hāsite lāgilā
the fun seeing the Lord to laugh began
tā-sabāke tāṁhā chāḍi' āge cali' gelā
them all there leaving ahead going He went

43 Seeing this delightful scene, the Lord began to laugh. Then He left them all there and went on ahead.

ময়ূরাদি পক্ষিগণ প্রভুরে দেখিয়া ।
সঙ্গে চলে, 'কৃষ্ণ' বলি' নাচে মত্ত হঞা ॥ ৪৪ ॥

mayūrādi pakṣi-gaṇa prabhure dekhiyā
peacocks and other birds the Lord seeing
saṅge cale, 'kṛṣṇa' bali' nāce matta hañā
along with Him go Kṛṣṇa saying dance maddened becoming

44 At the sight of the Lord, peacocks and other birds went along with Him, crying "Kṛṣṇa" and dancing as if mad.

‘হরিবোল’ বলি’ প্রভু করে উচ্চধ্বনি ।
বৃক্ষলতা — প্রফুল্লিত, সেই ধ্বনি শুনি’ ॥ ৪৫ ॥

‘hari-bola’ bali’ prabhu kare ucca-dhvani
“Hari bol” saying the Lord makes a loud call
vṛkṣa-latā — praphullita, sei dhvani śuni’
trees and creepers — rejoice that call hearing

45 The Lord called aloud, “Hari bol!” and the trees and creepers rejoiced to hear it.

In Jhārikhaṇḍa the Lord delivers all moving and nonmoving beings, that is, gives them devotion to Kṛṣṇa —

‘ঝারিখণ্ডে’ স্থাবর-জঙ্গম আছে যত ।
কৃষ্ণনাম দিয়া কৈল প্রেমেতে উন্মত্ত ॥ ৪৬ ॥

‘jhārikhaṇḍe’ sthāvara-jaṅgama āche yata
in Jhārikhaṇḍa the stationary and the moving are as many as
kṛṣṇa-nāma diyā kaila premete unmatta
Kṛṣṇa’s name giving He made with love mad

46 Giving Kṛṣṇa’s name to all the moving and nonmoving beings of Jhārikhaṇḍa, He made them mad with love.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Jhārikhaṇḍa is the name of a well-known forest region on the road to Vṛndāvana (today the hilly, forested states of Āṭagaṛa, Ḍheṅkānala, Āṅgula, Lāhārā, Kiyoñjhara, Bāmaṛā, Bonāi, Gāṅgapura, Choṭanāgapura, Yaśapura, Saragujā and others).

যেই গ্রাম দিয়া যান, যাঁহা করেন স্থিতি ।
সে-সব গ্রামের লোকের হয় ‘প্রেমভক্তি’ ॥ ৪৭ ॥

yei grāma diyā yāna, yāṁhā karena sthiti
which village through He goes where He makes a stay
se-saba grāmera lokera haya ‘prema-bhakti’
of all those villages in the people arises loving devotion

47 In every village He passed through or stayed in, the people gained loving devotion, *prema-bhakti*.

Along the Lord's path everyone becomes a Vaiṣṇava by hearing and chanting the name one from another —

কেহ যদি তাঁর মুখে শুনে কৃষ্ণনাম ।
তাঁর মুখে আন শুনে, তাঁর মুখে আন ॥ ৪৮ ॥

সবে ‘কৃষ্ণ’ ‘হরি’ বলি’ নাচে, কান্দে, হাসে ।
পরম্পরায় ‘বৈষ্ণব’ হইল সর্ব্বদেশে ॥ ৪৯ ॥

keha yadi tāṁra mukhe śune kṛṣṇa-nāma
anyone if His from the mouth hears Kṛṣṇa's name
tāṁra mukhe āna śune, tāṁra mukhe āna
his from the mouth another hears his from the mouth another
sabe ‘kṛṣṇa’ ‘hari’ bali’ nāce, kānde, hāse
all Kṛṣṇa Hari saying dance weep laugh
paramparāya ‘vaiṣṇava’ haila sarva-deśe
in succession Vaiṣṇavas became in every land

48–49 If anyone heard Kṛṣṇa's name from His mouth, another heard it from that person's mouth, and yet another from his. Saying "Kṛṣṇa!" and "Hari!", they all danced, wept and laughed, and so, one from another, people became Vaiṣṇavas in every land.

Anubhāṣya.
Āna means another person.

Though the Lord hides the signs of His love from outsiders, people attain devotion simply by seeing Him and hearing Him chant the name —

যদ্যপি প্রভু লোক-সংঘট্টের ত্রাসে ।
প্রেম ‘গুপ্ত’ করেন, বাহিরে না প্রকাশে ॥ ৫০ ॥

yadyapi prabhu loka-saṅghaṭṭera trāse
although the Lord of crowds of people in fear
prema 'gupta' karena, bāhire nā prakāśe
His love hidden keeps outwardly not shows

50 Although the Lord, wary of crowds, kept His love hidden and did not show it outwardly,

তথাপি তাঁর দর্শন-শ্রবণ-প্রভাবে ।
সকল দেশের লোক হৈল 'বৈষ্ণবে' ॥ ৫১ ॥

tathāpi tāṁra darśana-śravaṇa-prabhāve
still His of seeing and hearing by the power
sakala deśera loka haila 'vaiṣṇave'
of all lands the people became Vaiṣṇavas

51 still, by the power of seeing and hearing Him, the people of every land became Vaiṣṇavas.

The Lord delivers people throughout Bhārata-varṣa —

গৌড়, বঙ্গ, উৎকল, দক্ষিণ-দেশ গিয়া ।
লোকের নিস্তার কৈল আপনে ভ্রমিয়া ॥ ৫২ ॥

gauḍa, baṅga, utkala, dakṣiṇa-deśa giyā
to Gauḍa Vaṅga Utkala the southern lands going
lokera nistāra kaila āpane bhramiyā
of the people deliverance He brought Himself wandering

52 He Himself travelled through Gauḍa, Vaṅga, Utkala and the South and delivered the people.

In Jhārikhaṇḍa the Lord delivers even people utterly turned away from Kṛṣṇa —

মথুরা যাইবার ছলে আসেন ঝারিখণ্ড ।
ভিন্নপ্রায় লোক তাঁহা পরম-পাষণ্ড ॥ ৫৩ ॥

mathurā yāibāra chale āsena jhārikhaṇḍa
to Mathurā going on the pretext He comes to Jhārikhaṇḍa
bhinna-prāya loka tāṁhā parama-pāṣaṇḍa
almost savage the people there great unbelievers

53 Ostensibly on His way to Mathurā, He came to Jhārikhaṇḍa, where the people were half-savage and the worst of unbelievers.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhinna-prāya means living apart from civilized society, that is, "almost savage."

নাম-প্রেম দিয়া কৈল সবার নিস্তার ।
চৈতন্যের গূঢ়লীলা বুঝিতে শক্তি কার ॥ ৫৪ ॥

nāma-prema diyā kaila sabāra nistāra
the name and love giving He made of all the deliverance
caitanyera gūḍha-līlā bujhite śakti kāra
Caitanya's hidden pastimes to understand the power whose

54 Giving them the holy name and love, He delivered them all. Who has the power to understand the hidden pastimes of Caitanya?

*As befits a *mahā-bhāgavata*, the Lord's memories of the pastimes in Vraja are awakened —*

বন দেখি' ভ্রম হয় এই 'বৃন্দাবন' ।
শৈল দেখি' মনে হয় এই 'গোবর্দ্ধন' ॥ ৫৫ ॥

vana dekhi' bhrama haya ei 'vṛndāvana'
a forest seeing the illusion arises this Vṛndāvana
śaila dekhi' mane haya ei 'govardhana'
a hill seeing in the mind arises this Govardhana

55 Seeing a forest, He would take it for Vṛndāvana; seeing a hill, He would think it Govardhana.

যাঁহা নদী দেখে, তাঁহা মানয়ে ‘কালিন্দী’ ।
মহাপ্রেমাবেশে নাচে প্রভু পড়ে কান্দি’ ॥ ৫৬ ॥

yāṁhā nadī dekhe, tāṁhā mānaye ‘kālindī’
wherever a river He sees there He considers Kālindī
mahā-premāveśe nāce prabhu paḍe kāndi’
in a great trance of love dances the Lord falls weeping

56 Wherever He saw a river, He took it for the Kālindī. Overwhelmed by love, the Lord danced and fell down weeping.

Anubhāṣya.
On this one should especially study Madhya 8.11, 273 and 277, and the verses *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.30.9, 10.35.9 and others.

Bhaṭṭa serves the Lord —

পথে যাইতে ভট্টাচার্য্য শাক-মূল-ফল ।
যাঁহা যেই পায়েন, তাঁহা লয়েন সকল ॥ ৫৭ ॥

pathe yāite bhaṭṭācārya śāka-mūla-phala
on the road going the Bhaṭṭācārya greens, roots and fruits
yāṁhā yei pāyena, tāṁhā layena sakala
wherever whatever he finds there takes all

57 As they went along the road, the Bhaṭṭācārya gathered whatever greens, roots and fruits he could find.

Along the way it is Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇas who serve the Lord —

যে-গ্রামে রহেন প্রভু, তথায় ব্রাহ্মণ ।
পাঁচ-সাত জন আসি’ করে নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ৫৮ ॥

ye-grāme rahena prabhu, tathāya brāhmaṇa
in whatever village stays the Lord there brāhmaṇas
pāṁca-sāta jana āsi’ kare nimantraṇa
five or seven persons coming make an invitation

58 In whatever village the Lord stayed, five or seven brāhmaṇas would come and invite Him.

Everyone serves the Lord as best he can —

কেহ অন্ন আনি' দেয় ভট্টাচার্য্য-স্থানে ।
কেহ দুগ্ধ, দধি, কেহ ঘৃত, খণ্ড আনে ॥ ৫৯ ॥

keha anna āni' deya bhaṭṭācārya-sthāne
someone grain bringing gives of the Bhaṭṭācārya to the place
keha dugdha, dadhi, keha ghṛta, khaṇḍa āne
someone milk yogurt someone ghee sugar brings

59 Some brought grain and left it with the Bhaṭṭācārya; some brought milk and yogurt, and some ghee and sugar.

Brāhmaṇas by initiation serve the Lord —

যাঁহা বিপ্র নাহি, তাঁহা 'শূদ্রমহাজন' ।
আসি' সবে ভট্টাচার্য্যে করে নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ৬০ ॥

yāṁhā vipra nāhi, tāṁhā 'śūdra-mahājana'
where brāhmaṇas there are none there respectable śūdras
āsi' sabe bhaṭṭācārye kare nimantraṇa
coming all the Bhaṭṭācārya make invitation

60 Where there were no brāhmaṇas, respectable men of the *śūdra* community came and invited the Bhaṭṭācārya.

Anubhāṣya.
Where there were no brāhmaṇas by birth (*śaukra-vipras*), the Bhaṭṭācārya was invited to the homes of "*śūdra mahājanas*," that is, of great souls (*mahājanas*) who, though born *śūdras*, were brāhmaṇas by initiation (*daikṣya*) and the like. By the rules of Śaṅkara's *sannyāsīs*, alms may be accepted only in the home of a brāhmaṇa by birth. Yet where there were no Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇas, Mahāprabhu took no account of birth, either by seed (*śaukra*) or by the Sāvitrī initiation (*sāvitrya*). He looked only at whether a person was a Vaiṣṇava, that is, at pure

devotion, and accepted food and other things from brāhmaṇas by initiation and others.

How the Lord took His meals on the forest road —

ভট্টাচার্য্য পাক করে বন্য-ব্যঞ্জন ।
বন্য-ব্যঞ্জনে প্রভুর আনন্দিত মন ॥ ৬১ ॥

bhaṭṭācārya pāka kare vanya-vyañjana
the Bhaṭṭācārya cooking does of forest vegetables
vanya-vyañjane prabhura ānandita mana
with the forest vegetables the Lord's delighted mind

61 The Bhaṭṭācārya cooked vegetables from the forest, and the Lord was delighted with them.

দুই-চারি দিনের অন্ন রাখেন সংহতি ।
যাঁহা শূন্য বন, লোকের নাহিক বসতি ॥ ৬২ ॥

তাঁহা সেই অন্ন ভট্টাচার্য্য করে পাক ।
ফল-মূলে ব্যঞ্জন করে, বন্য নানা শাক ॥ ৬৩ ॥

dui-cāri dinera anna rākhena saṁhati
for two or four days grain he keeps with him
yāṁhā śūnya vana, lokera nāhika vasati
where empty forest of people there is no dwelling
tāṁhā sei anna bhaṭṭācārya kare pāka
there that grain the Bhaṭṭācārya does cooking
phala-mūle vyañjana kare, vanya nānā śāka
from fruits and roots vegetable dishes makes of the forest various greens

62–63 He kept with him grain for two or four days. Where the forest was empty and no one lived, the Bhaṭṭācārya cooked that grain and made dishes from fruits, roots and many kinds of forest greens.

পরম সন্তোষ প্রভুর বন্য-ভোজনে ।
মহাসুখ পান, যে-দিন রহেন নির্জ্জনে ॥ ৬৪ ॥

parama santoṣa prabhura vanya-bhojane
supreme satisfaction of the Lord in the forest fare
mahā-sukha pāna, ye-dina rahena nirjane
great happiness He finds on the day He remains in solitude

64 The Lord was perfectly content with the forest fare, and He was happiest on the days He spent in solitude.

Bhaṭṭa serves the Lord, and the brāhmaṇa who accompanies him carries the Lord's things —

ভট্টাচার্য্য সেবা করে, স্নেহে যৈছে 'দাস' ।
তাঁর বিপ্র বহে জলপাত্র-বহির্ব্বাস ॥ ৬৫ ॥

bhaṭṭācārya sevā kare, snehe yaiche 'dāsa'
the Bhaṭṭācārya service does with affection like a servant
tāṁra vipra vahe jala-pātra-bahirvāsa
his brāhmaṇa carries the waterpot and the outer cloth

65 The Bhaṭṭācārya served Him lovingly, like a servant, and his brāhmaṇa carried the waterpot and the outer cloth.

The Lord bathes in springs three times a day and warms Himself at a fire —

নির্ঝরেতে উষ্ণোদকে স্নান তিনবার ।
দুইসন্ধ্যা অগ্নিতাপ কাষ্ঠের অপার ॥ ৬৬ ॥

nirjharete uṣṇodake snāna tina-bāra
in the springs in warm water a bath three times
dui-sandhyā agni-tāpa kāṣṭhera apāra
at both twilights the warmth of a fire of wood without limit

66 He bathed three times a day in the warm water of springs, and at dawn and dusk He warmed Himself at a fire, for there was no end of firewood.

The Lord tells Bhaṭṭa about His earlier attempt to go to Vṛndāvana —

নিরন্তর প্রেমাবেশে নির্জ্জনে গমন ।
সুখ অনুভবি' প্রভু কহেন বচন ॥ ৬৭ ॥

nirantara premāveśe nirjane gamana
constantly in the ecstasy of love in solitude travelling
sukha anubhavi' prabhu kahena vacana
happiness feeling the Lord speaks words

67 Travelling in solitude, He was constantly absorbed in love. Feeling this happiness, the Lord said:

শুন, ভট্টাচার্য্য, — আমি গেলাঙ বহু-দেশ ।
বনপথে দুঃখের কাঁহা নাহি পাই লেশ ॥ ৬৮ ॥

śuna, bhaṭṭācārya, — āmi gelāṅa bahu-deśa
listen Bhaṭṭācārya — I have gone through many lands
vana-pathe duḥkhera kāṁhā nāhi pāi leśa
on the forest path of hardship anywhere not I find a trace

68 "Listen, Bhaṭṭācārya. I have travelled through many lands, but on this forest path I find not a trace of hardship anywhere.

কৃষ্ণ — কৃপালু, আমায় বহুত কৃপা কৈলা ।
বনপথে আনি' আমায় বড় সুখ দিলা ॥ ৬৯ ॥

kṛṣṇa — kṛpālu, āmāya bahuta kṛpā kailā
Kṛṣṇa — merciful to Me great mercy He showed
vana-pathe āni' āmāya baḍa sukha dilā
by the forest path bringing to Me great happiness He gave

69 Kṛṣṇa is merciful. He has shown Me great mercy: bringing Me by the forest path, He has given Me great happiness.

পূর্ব্বে বৃন্দাবন যাইতে করিলাঙ বিচার ।
মাতা, গঙ্গা, ভক্তগণে দেখিব একবার ॥ ৭০ ॥

pūrve vṛndāvana yāite karilāṅa vicāra
earlier to Vṛndāvana going I made a plan
mātā, gaṅgā, bhakta-gaṇe dekhiba eka-bāra
My mother the Gaṅgā the devotees I shall see once

70 Earlier, when I set out for Vṛndāvana, I thought, 'I shall see My mother, the Gaṅgā and the devotees once more.

ভক্তগণ-সঙ্গে অবশ্য করিব মিলন ।
ভক্তগণে সঙ্গে লঞা যাব 'বৃন্দাবন' ॥ ৭১ ॥

bhakta-gaṇa-saṅge avaśya kariba milana
with the devotees surely I shall make a meeting
bhakta-gaṇe saṅge lañā yāba 'vṛndāvana'
the devotees with Me taking I shall go to Vṛndāvana

71 I shall surely meet the devotees, and I shall take them with Me to Vṛndāvana.'

এত ভাবি' গৌড়দেশে করিলুঁ গমন ।
মাতা, গঙ্গা, ভক্তে দেখি' সুখী হৈল মন ॥ ৭২ ॥

eta bhāvi' gauḍa-deśe karilum̐ gamana
so thinking to Gauḍa I made My way
mātā, gaṅgā, bhakte dekhi' sukhī haila mana
My mother the Gaṅgā the devotees seeing happy became My mind

72 With this in mind I went to Gauḍa, and My heart was happy to see My mother, the Gaṅgā and the devotees.

ভক্তগণে লঞা তবে চলিলাঙ রঙ্গে ।
লক্ষকোটি লোক তাঁহা হৈল আমা-সঙ্গে ॥ ৭৩ ॥

bhakta-gaṇe lañā tabe calilāṅa raṅge
the devotees taking then I set out joyfully
lakṣa-koṭi loka tām̐hā haila āmā-saṅge
hundreds of thousands of people there became with Me

73 Then I joyfully set out with the devotees, and hundreds of thousands of people there joined Me.

সনাতন-মুখে কৃষ্ণ আমা শিখাইলা ।
তাহা বিঘ্ন করি' বনপথে লঞা আইলা ॥ ৭৪ ॥

sanātana-mukhe kṛṣṇa āmā śikhāilā
of Sanātana through the mouth Kṛṣṇa Me taught
tāhā vighna kari' vana-pathe lañā āilā
to that obstacle making by the forest path taking Me He brought

74 Kṛṣṇa taught Me through Sanātana's mouth. He put an end to that journey and brought Me by the forest path.

Words on the greatness of Kṛṣṇa's mercy —

কৃপার সমুদ্র, দীন-হীনে দয়াময় ।
কৃষ্ণকৃপা বিনা কোন 'সুখ' নাহি হয় ॥ ৭৫ ॥

kṛpāra samudra, dīna-hīne dayāmaya
of mercy the ocean to the poor and fallen compassionate
kṛṣṇa-kṛpā vinā kona 'sukha' nāhi haya
Kṛṣṇa's mercy without any happiness not there is

75 He is an ocean of mercy, compassionate to the poor and the fallen. Without Kṛṣṇa's mercy there is no happiness at all."

The Lord thanks Bhaṭṭa for his service —

ভট্টাচার্য্যে আলিঙ্গিয়া তাঁহারে কহিল ।
তোমার প্রসাদে এত সুখ পাইল ॥ ৭৬ ॥

bhaṭṭācārye āliṅgiyā tāṁhāre kahila
the Bhaṭṭācārya embracing to him He said
tomāra prasāde eta sukha pāila
by your grace so much happiness I have found

76 Embracing the Bhaṭṭācārya, He said to him, “By your kindness I have found so much happiness.”

Bhaṭṭa speaks humbly of himself and offers praise —

তেঁহো কহেন, — তুমি ‘কৃষ্ণ’, তুমি ‘দয়াময়’ ।
অধম জীব মুঞি, মোরে হইলা সদয় ॥ ৭৭ ॥

teṁho kahena, — tumi ‘kṛṣṇa’, tumi ‘dayāmaya’
he says — You are Kṛṣṇa You are merciful
adhama jīva muñi, more hailā sadaya
a fallen soul I to me You have been kind

77 He replied, “You are Kṛṣṇa! You are merciful! I am a fallen soul, yet You have been kind to me.

মুঞি ছার, মোরে তুমি সঙ্গে লঞা আইলা ।
কৃপা করি’ মোর হাতে ‘প্রভু’ ভিক্ষা কৈলা ॥ ৭৮ ॥

muñi chāra, more tumi saṅge lañā āilā
I am insignificant me You with You taking have come
kṛpā kari’ mora hāte ‘prabhu’ bhikṣā kailā
mercy showing from my hand the Lord meals has taken

78 I am worthless, yet You have brought me with You. In Your mercy, my Lord, You have taken Your meals from my hand.

অধম-কাকেরে কৈলা গরুড়-সমান ।
‘স্বতন্ত্র ঈশ্বর’ তুমি — স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ॥ ৭৯ ॥

adhama-kākere kailā garuḍa-samāna
a lowly crow You have made equal to Garuḍa
‘svatantra īśvara’ tumi — svayaṁ bhagavān
the independent Lord You — Svayam Bhagavān

79 You have made a lowly crow equal to Garuḍa. You are the independent Lord, *Svayam Bhagavān* Himself.”

*The words of Śrīdhara Svāmī, the sixth verse of the *maṅgalācaraṇa* at the beginning of his commentary on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.1.1 in the *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* —*

মূকং করোতি বাচালং পঙ্গুং লঙ্ঘয়তে গিরিম্ ।
যৎকৃপা তমহং বন্দে পরমানন্দ-মাধবম্ ॥ ৮০ ॥

mūkaṁ karoti vācālaṁ
the mute makes eloquent
paṅguṁ laṅghayate girim
the lame makes cross a mountain
yat-kṛpā tam ahaṁ vande
whose mercy to Him I bow down
paramānanda-mādhavam
Mādhava who is the supreme bliss

80 "I bow down to Mādhava, the supreme bliss, whose mercy makes the mute eloquent and lets the lame cross a mountain." (Śrīdhara Svāmī, *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.1)[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Mādhava, the embodiment of supreme bliss (*paramānanda-svarūpa*), whose mercy can make the mute eloquent and enable the lame to cross a mountain.

Anubhāṣya.
yat (whose) **kṛpā** (mercy) **mūkam** (even one without the power of speech) **vācālam** (eloquent, devoted to singing of Kṛṣṇa) **karoti** (makes), **paṅgum** (even one unable to walk) **girim** (a mountain) **laṅghayate** (makes cross; that is, enables one to accomplish even the impossible in the service of Kṛṣṇa), **paramānanda-mādhavam** (Śrī Paramānanda Svāmī, of the line of Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī, and my own worshipful Lord, Śrī Bhagavān) **aham vande** (I worship).

Bhaṭṭa pleases the Lord by his service —

এইমত বলভদ্র করেন স্তবন ।
প্রেমসেবা করি' তুষ্ট কৈল প্রভুর মন ॥ ৮১ ॥

ei-mata balabhadra karena stavana
thus Balabhadra offers praise
prema-sevā kari' tuṣṭa kaila prabhura mana
loving service rendering pleased he made the Lord's mind

81 In this way Balabhadra offered praise, and by his loving service he pleased the Lord.

Arriving in Kāśī, the Lord bathes at Maṇikarṇikā —

এইমত নানা-সুখে প্রভু আইলা 'কাশী' ।
মধ্যাহ্ন-স্নান কৈল মণিকর্ণিকায় আসি' ॥ ৮২ ॥

ei-mata nānā-sukhe prabhu āilā 'kāśī'
thus in many joys the Lord came to Kāśī
madhyāhna-snāna kaila maṇikarṇikāya āsi'
His midday bath He took at Maṇikarṇikā coming

82 So the Lord came joyfully to Kāśī, and there He took His midday bath at Maṇikarṇikā.

Anubhāṣya.

Kāśī, also called Vārāṇasī or Avimukta, is a most ancient city: "Ever since the Asi and the Varuṇā were appointed guardians of this holy land, O great sage, Kāśikā, having gained the confluence of the Asi and the Varuṇā, has been known as Vārāṇasī."

Maṇikarṇikā: at this *ghāṭa* a jewel (*maṇi*) fell from the ear (*karṇa*) of Viṣṇu, or, some say, from the ear of Śiva; hence its name, Maṇikarṇikā. Others say that Viśvanātha, the physician of the disease of worldly existence, delivers the dying residents of Kāśī by placing in their ear the *tāraka-brahma*, the name of Rāma; therefore this holy place is called Maṇikarṇikā. "There is no holy place equal to the Gaṅgā, especially in Vārāṇasī; and there, too, is the holy place named Maṇikarṇā, dear to Viśveśvara." The *Kāśī-khaṇḍa* says: "Here, at the hour of death, Śiva at once speaks into the earlobe (*karṇikā*) of the virtuous that *tāraka*, the wish-fulfilling gem (*cintāmaṇi*) for those bound in *saṁsāra*; therefore this place is sung of as Maṇikarṇikā. It is the jewel (*maṇi*) of the great seat of Lakṣmī of liberation, and the whorl (*karṇikā*) of the lotuses of His feet; therefore people call it Maṇikarṇikā."

At that time Tapana Miśra too is bathing; on seeing the Lord he is at first astonished —

সেইকালে তপনমিশ্র করে গঙ্গাস্নান ।
প্রভু দেখি' হৈল তাঁর কিছু বিস্ময় জ্ঞান ॥ ৮৩ ॥

sei-kāle tapana-miśra kare gaṅgā-snāna
at that time Tapana Miśra takes a bath in the Gaṅgā
prabhu dekhi' haila tāṁra kichu vismaya jñāna
the Lord seeing arose in him some wonder feeling

83 At that time Tapana Miśra was bathing in the Gaṅgā, and he was surprised to see the Lord there.

'পূর্ব্বে শুনিয়াছি প্রভু কর্য্যাছেন সন্ন্যাস' ।
নিশ্চয় করিয়া, হৈল হৃদয়ে উল্লাস ॥ ৮৪ ॥

'pūrve śuniyāchi prabhu karyāchena sannyāsa'
earlier I have heard the Lord has taken sannyāsa
niścaya kariyā, haila hṛdaye ullāsa
certainty making arose in his heart joy

84 "I heard earlier that the Lord had taken *sannyāsa*," he thought, and when he was sure it was He, his heart filled with joy.

Then, tears of joy —

প্রভুর চরণ ধরি' করেন রোদন ।
প্রভু তাঁরে উঠাঞা কৈল আলিঙ্গন ॥ ৮৫ ॥

prabhura caraṇa dhari' karena rodana
the Lord's feet clasping he does weeping
prabhu tāṁre uṭhāñā kaila āliṅgana
the Lord him raising made embrace

85 Clasping the Lord's feet, he wept, and the Lord raised him up and embraced him.

*Miśra takes the Lord for *darśana* of Viśveśvara and Bindu-mādhava —*

প্রভু লঞা গেলা বিশ্বেশ্বর-দরশনে ।
তবে আসি' দেখে বিন্দুমাধব চরণে ॥ ৮৬ ॥

prabhu lañā gelā viśveśvara-daraśane
the Lord taking he went to the darśana of Viśveśvara
tabe āsi' dekhe bindu-mādhava caraṇe
then coming sees Bindu-mādhava's feet

86 He took the Lord to see Viśveśvara, and then they came and saw the feet of Bindu-mādhava.

Anubhāṣya.

Bindu-mādhava is an ancient temple of Viṣṇu; today it is the temple known as Veṇī-mādhava. It stands above the Pañcagaṅgā. Of the five rivers (the "Pañcanadī")—the Dhūtapāpā, the Kiraṇā, the Sarasvatī, the Gaṅgā and the Yamunā—only the Gaṅgā flows visibly. It is said that the ancient temple of Bindu-mādhava, which Śrī Mahāprabhu visited, was destroyed by the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb, "the hater of Hindus," who built a large mosque in its place. The huge old mosque stands right beside the present temple.

In the temple reside the Deities of four-armed Śrī Nārāyaṇa and Lakṣmī-devī; before Them is the Deity of Śrī Garuḍa, and to the side the Deities of Śrī Rāma, Sītā, Lakṣmaṇa and others, and of Śrī Hanumān. The Deities' service and all the temple's expenses are borne by Śrīmant Bālāsāheb Pant Mahārāj, the *pratinidhi* of Āundh—a tributary native state in the Sātārā district of Mahārāṣṭra, in the Bombay Presidency—a Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa who follows a Vaiṣṇava *sampradāya*. The service of Śrī Veṇī-mādhava is said to have been entrusted to this royal family for about 200 years; the first servitor (*pratinidhi*) of the line was named Mahārāj Jagatjīvan Rāo Sāheb.

Miśra brings the Lord to his home and rejoices at having received Him —

ঘরে লঞা আইলা প্রভুকে আনন্দিত হঞা ।
সেবা করি' নৃত্য করে বস্ত্র উড়াঞা ॥ ৮৭ ॥

ghare lañā āilā prabhuke ānandita hañā
home taking he brought the Lord joyful becoming
sevā kari' nṛtya kare vastra uḍāñā
service rendering dance he does his cloth waving

87 Full of joy, he brought the Lord home, served Him, and danced, waving his cloth.

Anubhāṣya.
(In Tapana Miśra's house.) While staying in Kāśī, Śrīman Mahāprabhu would bathe at the nearby "Pañcanadī Ghāṭa," then first of all go for *darśana* of Śrī Bindu-mādhava-jīu, and afterwards accept His meal in the house of Śrī Tapana Miśra. A little way from that temple stands a banyan tree under which, tradition says, Śrīman Mahāprabhu used to rest. It is said that the tree was later named "Caitanya-vaṭa" after Him and in time came to be called "Yatana-vaṭa," and it is still known by that name. Today, in a lane there, one can see the *samādhi* of Śrī Vallabhācārya, but no memorial of Śrī Gaurasundara is to be found. Vallabhācārya, too, is known to his followers by the name "Mahāprabhu." Śrīman Mahāprabhu may have stayed at the "Yatana-vaṭa," but even the traces of Śrī Candraśekhara's house, of Śrī Tapana Miśra's home, of the place of Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, the leader of the Māyāvādīs, and so on, are now lost. Nearby, however, in the house of the late Śaśībhūṣaṇa Niyogī of Calcutta, the Deities (*arcā-vigrahas*) of Śrī Gaura and Nityānanda are installed. The present service is carried on under the care of his mother-in-law and of his wife's sister's husband, Śrī Nārāyaṇacandra Ghoṣa.

Miśra and his whole family drink the water that washed the Lord's feet, and he honours Bhaṭṭa —

প্রভুর চরণোদক সবংশে কৈল পান ।
ভট্টাচার্য্যের পূজা কৈল করিয়া সম্মান ॥ ৮৮ ॥

prabhura caraṇodaka savaṁśe kaila pāna
of the Lord the water from His feet with all his family he made drinking
bhaṭṭācāryera pūjā kaila kariyā sammāna
of the Bhaṭṭācārya worship he made showing honour

88 With all his family he drank the water that had washed the Lord's feet, and he honoured the Bhaṭṭācārya with worship.

Bhaṭṭa cooks the Lord's meal —

প্রভুরে নিমন্ত্রণ করি' ঘরে ভিক্ষা দিল ।
বলভদ্র-ভট্টাচার্য্যে পাক করাইল ॥ ৮৯ ॥

prabhure nimantraṇa kari' ghare bhikṣā dila
the Lord invitation making at home meals he gave
balabhadra-bhaṭṭācārye pāka karāila
Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya cooking he had do

89 He invited the Lord and fed Him in his home, having Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya do the cooking.

After His meal the Lord lies down, and Raghunātha massages His feet —

ভিক্ষা করি' মহাপ্রভু করিলা শয়ন ।
মিশ্রপুত্র রঘু করে পাদ-সম্বাহন ॥ ৯০ ॥

bhikṣā kari' mahāprabhu karilā śayana
meal taking Mahāprabhu made lying down
miśra-putra raghu kare pāda-samvāhana
Miśra's son Raghu does massaging of the feet

90 After His meal Mahāprabhu lay down to rest, and Miśra's son Raghu massaged His feet.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Tapana Miśra's son Raghunātha, who later became famous as "Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī," began to massage the Lord's feet.

Miśra and his whole family accept the Lord's remnants; Candraśekhara arrives —

প্রভুর 'শেষান্ন' মিশ্র সবংশে খাইল ।
'প্রভু আইলা' শুনি' চন্দ্রশেখর আইল ॥ ৯১ ॥

prabhura 'śeṣānna' miśra savaṁśe khāila
the Lord's remnants of food Miśra with all his family ate
'prabhu āilā' śuni' candraśekhara āila
the Lord has come hearing Candraśekhara came

91 Miśra and all his family ate the Lord's remnants. Hearing that the Lord had come, Candraśekhara came too.

Who Candraśekhara was —

মিশ্রের সখা তেঁহো প্রভুর পূর্ব্ব দাস ।
বৈদ্যজাতি, লিখনবৃত্তি, বারাণসী-বাস ॥ ৯২ ॥

miśrera sakhā teṁho prabhura pūrva dāsa
Miśra's friend he the Lord's old servant
vaidya-jāti, likhana-vṛtti, vārāṇasī-vāsa
a vaidya by caste a scribe by profession living in Vārāṇasī

92 He was Miśra's friend and an old servant of the Lord. A *vaidya* by caste and a scribe by profession, he lived in Vārāṇasī.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Likhana-vṛtti means earning one's living by copying manuscripts.

Candraśekhara sees the Lord and bows down; the Lord embraces him —

আসি' প্রভু-পদে পড়ি' করেন রোদন ।
প্রভু তাঁরে কৃপায় উঠি' কৈল আলিঙ্গন ॥ ৯৩ ॥

āsi' prabhu-pade paḍi' karena rodana
coming at the Lord's feet falling he does weeping
prabhu tāṁre kṛpāya uṭhi' kaila āliṅgana
the Lord him mercifully rising made embrace

93 He came, fell at the Lord's feet and wept, and the Lord rose and mercifully embraced him.

Candraśekhara tells the Lord of his grief —

চন্দ্রশেখর কহে, — প্রভু, বড় কৃপা কৈলা ।
আপনে আসিয়া ভৃত্যে দরশন দিলা ॥ ৯৪ ॥

candraśekhara kahe, — prabhu, baḍa kṛpā kailā
Candraśekhara says — O Lord great mercy You have shown
āpane āsiyā bhṛtye daraśana dilā
Yourself coming to Your servant darśana You gave

94 Candraśekhara said, "Lord, You have shown me great mercy: You came Yourself to give Your servant Your darśana.

Kāśī, empty of talk of serving Hari, is the abode of dry Māyāvādīs —

আপন-'প্রারব্ধে' বসি' বারাণসী-স্থানে ।
'মায়া', 'ব্রহ্ম' শব্দ বিনা নাহি শুনি কানে ॥ ৯৫ ॥

āpana-'prārabdhe' vasi' vārāṇasī-sthāne
by my own prārabdha living in Vārāṇasī
'māyā', 'brahma' śabda vinā nāhi śuni kāne
māyā Brahman words except not I hear with my ears

95 By my own *prārabdha*, the karma now bearing fruit, I live in Vārāṇasī, and my ears hear nothing but the words '*māyā*' and 'Brahman.'

Anubhāṣya.

Prārabdhe, "by *prārabdha*." Kāśī is the foremost holy place (*tīrtha*) of the Śaivas and the *pañcopāsakas*, the worshippers of the five deities. But there is no talk there of serving Śrī Hari, and so it is utterly unfit as a dwelling for a devotee of Gaura (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.19.3).[8] So Candraśekhara said with great sorrow that he lived there only because of his past sins. Here the word *prārabdha* is used in self-reproach.

(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Pūrva-vibhāga, First Laharī:) "The sin that causes a low birth is *prārabdha*." A pure devotee of the Lord may call himself one who reaps his *prārabdha*, the fruits of his past deeds, but he himself in no way reaps the fruits of good and bad deeds as do other mortals, who are subject to the punishment of Yama. What to speak of the *nitya-siddhas* or *sādhana-siddhas*:

even in the stage of practice, a *jīva's* *sādhana-bhakti* is *kleśaghnī*: it destroys the three kinds of affliction (*kleśa*)—sin (*pāpa*), the seed of sin (*pāpa-bīja*) and ignorance (*avidyā*). Thus the *Padma Purāṇa* says: “Sin whose fruits have not yet begun, sin in its germ (*kūṭa*), its seed (*bīja*), and sin about to bear fruit —all gradually vanish for those whose hearts are devoted to serving Viṣṇu.” In this connection one should also study the *Durgama-saṅgamanī* commentary on the two preceding verses.

Candraśekhara honours Miśra —

ষড়্দর্শন-ব্যাখ্যা বিনা কথা নাহি এথা ।
মিশ্র কৃপা করি’ মোরে শুনান কৃষ্ণকথা ॥ ৯৬ ॥

ṣaḍ-darśana-vyākhyā vinā kathā nāhi ethā
of the six philosophies the explanation except talk there is no here
miśra kṛpā kari’ more śunāna kṛṣṇa-kathā
Miśra mercy showing to me makes hear talks of Kṛṣṇa

96 Here there is no talk but explanations of the six philosophies; but Miśra, in his kindness, lets me hear talks of Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
The six *darśanas* (philosophical systems) are: (1) the Vaiśeṣika system of the sage Kaṇāda; (2) the Nyāya system of the sage Gotama; (3) the Yoga system of the sage Patañjali; (4) the Sāṅkhya system of the sage Kapila; (5) the Pūrva (Karma) Mīmāṁsā of the sage Jaimini; (6) the Uttara (Brahma) Mīmāṁsā, or Vedānta, of the great sage Vedavyāsa.

A plaintive prayer to the Lord —

নিরন্তর দুঁহে চিন্তি তোমার চরণ ।
‘সর্ব্বজ্ঞ ঈশ্বর’ তুমি দিলা দরশন ॥ ৯৭ ॥

nirantara duṁhe cinti tomāra caraṇa
constantly we two meditate on Your feet
‘sarvajña īśvara’ tumi dilā daraśana
the omniscient Lord You have given darśana

97 We two constantly meditate on Your feet, and You, the omniscient Lord, have given us Your darśana.

শুনি, — ‘মহাপ্রভু’ যাবেন শ্রীবৃন্দাবনে ।
দিন কত রহি’ তার’ ভৃত্য দুইজনে ॥ ৯৮ ॥

śuni, — ‘mahāprabhu’ yābena śrī-vṛndāvane
I hear — Mahāprabhu will go to Śrī Vṛndāvana
dina kata rahi’ tāra’ bhṛtya dui-jane
days a few staying deliver servants two

98 I hear that Mahāprabhu is going to Śrī Vṛndāvana. Stay a few days and deliver Your two servants.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Tāra means “deliver.” *Bhṛtya duijane*, “two servants,” means the two of them: Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra.

Anubhāṣya.
Though they are very close to the Lord, they address Him with the greatest reverence.

Miśra's request to the Lord —

মিশ্র কহে, — প্রভু, যাবৎ কাশীতে রহিবা ।
মোর নিমন্ত্রণ বিনা অন্য না মানিবা ॥ ৯৯ ॥

miśra kahe, — prabhu, yāvat kāśīte rahibā
Miśra says — O Lord as long as in Kāśī You stay
mora nimantraṇa vinā anya nā mānibā
my invitation except any other not You will accept

99 Miśra said, “Lord, as long as You stay in Kāśī, please accept no invitation but mine.”

Bhagavān is controlled by His devotees —

এইমত মহাপ্রভু দুই ভৃত্যের বশে ।
ইচ্ছা নাহি, তবু তথা রহিলা দিন-দশে ॥ ১০০ ॥

ei-mata mahāprabhu dui bhṛtyera vaśe
thus Mahāprabhu of two servants under the control
icchā nāhi, tabu tathā rahilā dina-daśe
desire there was none yet there He stayed for ten days

100 So Mahāprabhu, yielding to His two servants, stayed there ten days, though He had no wish to.

Anubhāṣya.

Dina-daśe, "some ten days." Madhya 1.239 mentions that on this journey the Lord stayed four days in Tapana Miśra's house in Kāśī.

The Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa comes and becomes the Lord's follower —

মহারাষ্ট্রীয় বিপ্র আইসে প্রভু দেখিবারে ।
প্রভুর রূপ-প্রেম দেখি' হয় চমৎকারে ॥ ১০১ ॥

mahārāṣṭrīya vipra āise prabhu dekhibāre
a Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa comes the Lord to see
prabhura rūpa-prema dekhi' haya camatkāre
the Lord's beauty and love seeing becomes amazed

101 A brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra would come to see the Lord, and he marvelled at His beauty and His love.

Māyāvādī brāhmaṇas, who are not Vaiṣṇavas, are unfit to feed the Lord —

বিপ্র সব নিমন্ত্রয়, প্রভু নাহি মানে ।
প্রভু কহে, — আজি মোর হঞাছে নিমন্ত্রণে ॥ ১০২ ॥

vipra saba nimantraya, prabhu nāhi māne
the brāhmaṇas all invite the Lord not accepts
prabhu kahe, — āji mora hañāche nimantraṇe
the Lord says — today My there has been invitation

102 All the brāhmaṇas invited Him, but the Lord would not accept. “Today I already have an invitation,” He would say.

*The Lord, playing the role of an *ācārya*, avoids the company of Māyāvādīs —*

এইমত প্রতিদিন করেন বঞ্চন ।
সন্ন্যাসীর সঙ্গ-ভয়ে না মানেন নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ১০৩ ॥

ei-mata prati-dina karena vañcana
thus every day He does evading
sannyāsīra saṅga-bhaye nā mānena nimantraṇa
of the sannyāsīs of the company in fear not He accepts invitations

103 In this way He evaded them every day. Wary of the company of the *sannyāsīs*, He accepted no invitations.

Prakāśānanda, with many disciples, expounds Māyāvāda —

প্রকাশানন্দ শ্রীপাদ সভাতে বসিয়া ।
‘বেদান্ত’ পড়ান বহু শিষ্যগণ লঞা ॥ ১০৪ ॥

prakāśānanda śrīpāda sabhāte vasiyā
Prakāśānanda Śrīpāda in the assembly sitting
‘vedānta’ paḍāna bahu śiṣya-gaṇa lañā
Vedānta teaches many disciples taking

104 Prakāśānanda Śrīpāda sat in his assembly and taught Vedānta to his many disciples.

Anubhāṣya.
Prakāśānanda was an *ekadaṇḍī* *sannyāsī* of the Śaṅkara *sampradāya* who lived in Kāśī in the time of Śrī Mahāprabhu. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 3: “‘I have no hands, no feet, no face, no eyes’—so he mocks Me with the Vedas. In Kāśī that rascal Prakāśānanda teaches; that rascal cuts My body to pieces. He explains the Vedas but does not accept My form (*vigraha*). His whole body is stricken with leprosy, yet he does not know it. My body, the embodiment of all sacrifices, is pure; Aja, Bhava and others sing of its deeds. By touching that body

even ‘*puṇya*’ gains purity. How does that rascal dare call it ‘false’!” Again, Madhya, Chapter 20: “The ‘*sannyāsī*’ ‘Prakāśānanda’ sits in Kāśī; that rascal cuts Me thoroughly to pieces. He teaches ‘Vedānta’ but does not accept My ‘*vigraha*.’ I have struck his body with leprosy, yet he does not know it. My ‘pastimes and deeds’ are ‘true,’ My ‘abode’ is ‘true.’ He calls this ‘false’ and hacks Me to bits.”

The guru of Śrīla Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, his uncle in his former *āśrama*, who lived in Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra, was the Rāmānujīya *jīyar svāmī*, the *tridaṇḍipāda* Śrī Śrīmat Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī. He and this Prakāśānanda are by no means one and the same person.

A brāhmaṇa describes the Lord to Prakāśānanda —

এক বিপ্র দেখি’ আইলা প্রভুর ব্যবহার ।
প্রকাশানন্দ-আগে কহে চরিত্র তাঁহার ॥ ১০৫ ॥

eka vipra dekhi’ āilā prabhura vyavahāra
one brāhmaṇa having seen came the Lord’s conduct
prakāśānanda-āge kahe caritra tāṁhāra
before Prakāśānanda tells the character His

105 One brāhmaṇa who had seen the Lord’s conduct came and told Prakāśānanda about Him.

এক সন্ন্যাসী আইলা জগন্নাথ হৈতে ।
তাঁহার মহিমা-প্রতাপ না পারি বর্ণিতে ॥ ১০৬ ॥

eka sannyāsī āilā jagannātha haite
one sannyāsī has come Jagannātha from
tāṁhāra mahimā-pratāpa nā pāri varṇite
His glory and power not I can describe

106 “A *sannyāsī* has come from Jagannātha Purī. I cannot describe His glory and power.

All the marks of Īśvara are present in the Lord —

সকল দেখিয়ে তাঁতে অদ্ভুত-কথন ।
প্রকাণ্ড-শরীর, শুদ্ধকাঞ্চন-বরণ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

sakala dekhiye tāṁte adbhuta-kathana
everything I see in Him wonderful to tell
prakāṇḍa-śarīra, śuddha-kāñcana-varaṇa
a tall body the colour of pure gold

107 Everything I see in Him is wonderful to tell: His body is tall and powerful, and His complexion is like pure gold.

আজানুলম্বিত ভুজ, কমল-নয়ন ।
যত কিছু ঈশ্বরের সর্ব্ব সল্লক্ষণ ॥ ১০৮ ॥

ājānu-lambita bhuja, kamala-nayana
reaching to the knees arms lotus eyes
yata kichu īśvarera sarva sal-lakṣaṇa
whatever there are of the Lord all auspicious marks

108 His arms reach to His knees, His eyes are like lotuses, and He bears every auspicious mark of the Lord.

*All the marks of Īśvara, or of a *mahā-bhāgavata*, described in the *Bhāgavatam* are present in the Lord —*

তাহা দেখি' জ্ঞান হয় — 'এই নারায়ণ' ।
যেই তাঁরে দেখে, করে কৃষ্ণসংকীর্ত্তন ॥ ১০৯ ॥

tāhā dekhi' jñāna haya — 'ei nārāyaṇa'
that seeing the understanding arises — this is Nārāyaṇa
yei tāṁre dekhe, kare kṛṣṇa-saṁkīrtana
whoever Him sees does the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa

109 Seeing these marks, one understands, 'This is Nārāyaṇa.' Whoever sees Him begins to chant the names of Kṛṣṇa.

‘মহাভাগবত’-লক্ষণ শুনি ভাগবতে ।
সে সব লক্ষণ প্রকট দেখিয়ে তাঁহাতে ॥ ১১০ ॥

‘mahā-bhāgavata’-lakṣaṇa śuni bhāgavate
of a mahā-bhāgavata the marks I hear in the Bhāgavata
se saba lakṣaṇa prakaṭa dekhiye tāṁhāte
those all marks manifest I see in Him

110 I hear in the *Bhāgavata* the marks of a *mahā-bhāgavata*, a great devotee, and I see all those marks plainly in Him.

‘নিরন্তর কৃষ্ণনাম’ জিহ্বা তাঁর গায় ।
দুই-নেত্রে অশ্রু বহে গঙ্গাধারা-প্রায় ॥ ১১১ ॥

‘nirantara kṛṣṇa-nāma’ jihvā tāṁra gāya
unceasingly Kṛṣṇa’s name tongue His sings
dui-netre aśru vahe gaṅgā-dhārā-prāya
from His two eyes tears flow like the streams of the Gaṅgā

111 His tongue sings Kṛṣṇa’s name unceasingly, and tears flow from His eyes like the streams of the Gaṅgā.

ক্ষণে নাচে, হাসে, গায়, করয়ে ক্রন্দন ।
ক্ষণে হুহুঙ্কার করে, — সিংহের গর্জ্জন ॥ ১১২ ॥

kṣaṇe nāce, hāse, gāya, karaye krandana
at times He dances laughs sings does weeping
kṣaṇe huhuṅkāra kare, — siṁhera garjana
at times loud roars He makes — of a lion the roaring

112 At times He dances, laughs, sings and weeps; at times He roars like a lion.

The name of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, whose name, form, qualities and pastimes are

not of this world —

জগৎমঙ্গল তাঁর 'কৃষ্ণচৈতন্য'-নাম ।
নাম, রূপ, গুণ তাঁর, সব — অনুপম ॥ ১১৩ ॥

jagat-maṅgala tāṁra 'kṛṣṇa-caitanya'-nāma
auspicious for the world His name "Kṛṣṇa Caitanya"
nāma, rūpa, guṇa tāṁra, saba — anupama
name form qualities His all — incomparable

113 His name, 'Kṛṣṇa Caitanya,' brings good to the whole world. His name, form and qualities are all beyond compare.

One who has faith, on seeing Īśvara, understands His deeds by His mercy; but hearing by the path of logic alone is fruitless —

দেখিলে সে জানি তাঁর 'ঈশ্বরের রীতি' ।
অলৌকিক কথা শুনি' কে করে প্রতীতি ? ॥ ১১৪ ॥

dekhile se jāni tāṁra 'īśvarera rīti'
seeing then one knows His of the Lord ways
alaukika kathā śuni' ke kare pratīti?
uncommon account hearing who will make belief

114 When you see Him, you know that His ways are the ways of the Lord. But who would believe such an extraordinary account just by hearing it?"

Hearing of the Lord, Prakāśānanda, a follower of the path of logic, ridicules and scorns Him —

শুনিয়া প্রকাশানন্দ বহুত হাসিলা ।
বিপ্রে উপহাস করি' কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ১১৫ ॥

śuniyā prakāśānanda bahuta hāsilā
hearing Prakāśānanda much laughed
vipre upahāsa kari' kahite lāgilā
at the brāhmaṇa mockery making to speak began

115 Hearing this, Prakāśānanda laughed heartily, and mocking the brāhmaṇa, he said:

Prakāśānanda spews out the poison of his Māyāvāda —

শুনিয়াছি গৌড়দেশের সন্ন্যাসী — 'ভাবুক' ।
কেশব-ভারতী-শিষ্য, লোকপ্রতারক ॥ ১১৬ ॥

śuniyāchi gauḍa-deśera sannyāsī — 'bhāvuka'
I have heard of Gauḍa the sannyāsī — a sentimentalist
keśava-bhāratī-śiṣya, loka-pratāraka
a disciple of Keśava Bhāratī a deceiver of people

116 "I have heard of Him — the sentimental *sannyāsī* from Gauḍa, a disciple of Keśava Bhāratī and a deceiver of people.

'চৈতন্য'-নাম তাঁর, ভাবুকগণ লঞা ।
দেশে-দেশে, গ্রামে-গ্রামে বুলে নাচাঞা ॥ ১১৭ ॥

'caitanya'-nāma tāṁra, bhāvuka-gaṇa lañā
Caitanya name His sentimentalists taking
deśe-deśe, grāme-grāme bule nācāñā
from land to land from village to village wanders making them dance

117 His name is Caitanya. He goes about with His sentimentalists from land to land and village to village, making them dance.

যেই তাঁরে দেখে, সেই ঈশ্বর করি' কহে ।
ঐছে মোহন-বিদ্যা — যে দেখে, সে মোহে ॥ ১১৮ ॥

yei tāṁre dekhe, sei īśvara kari' kahe
whoever Him sees he God taking Him for says
aiche mohana-vidyā — ye dekhe, se mohe
such the art of enchanting whoever sees he is bewildered

118 Whoever sees Him declares Him to be God. Such is His art of enchantment: whoever looks at Him falls under its spell.

সার্ব্বভৌম ভট্টাচার্য্য — পণ্ডিত প্রবল ।
শুনি' চৈতন্যের সঙ্গে হইল পাগল ॥ ১১৯ ॥

sārvabhauma bhaṭṭācārya — paṇḍita prabala
Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya a scholar formidable
śuni' caitanyera saṅge haila pāgala
I have heard Caitanya's in the company became mad

119 Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya is a formidable scholar, yet I hear that in Caitanya's company he has gone mad.

'সন্ন্যাসী' — নাম-মাত্র, মহা-ইন্দ্রজালী ।
'কাশীপুরে' না বিকাবে তাঁর ভাবকালি ॥ ১২০ ॥

'sannyāsī' — nāma-mātra, mahā-indrajālī
a sannyāsī in name only a great conjurer
'kāśīpure' nā vikābe tāṁra bhāvakāli
in Kāśī not will sell His wares of emotion

120 He is a *sannyāsī* in name only; in fact He is a great conjurer. But here in Kāśī His wares of emotion will not sell.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhāva-kāli means the ways of a *bhāvuka*, a sentimentalist.

'বেদান্ত' শ্রবণ কর, না যাইহ তাঁর পাশ ।
উচ্ছৃঙ্খল-লোক-সঙ্গে দুইলোক-নাশ ॥ ১২১ ॥

'vedānta' śravaṇa kara, nā yāiha tāṁra pāśa
Vedānta hearing do do not go His to the side
ucchṛṅkhala-loka-saṅge dui-loka-nāśa
of unruly people in the company of both worlds ruin

121 Keep hearing Vedānta and do not go near Him. The company of unruly people ruins both this world and the next."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Keeping company with those who have broken the chains of scriptural injunction ruins both worlds, this one and the next.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhāvuka. The Māyāvādī Prakāśānanda applies this epithet here because he takes two things to be “one and the same.” One is the supremely wonderful, transcendental, spiritual feeling (*bhāva*) of Śrīman Mahāprabhu. The other is the artificial, short-lived and unruly outburst of those who cultivate *mano-dharma*, mind-made religion. The Māyāvādī regards even a pure devotee's transcendental loud chanting of Kṛṣṇa, his dancing and playing of instruments as “the same as” or “equal to” *tauryatrika*—the singing, dancing and music meant for worldly sense enjoyment. He considers it mere sensual effort, like servitude to the six enemies. Therefore he is called an *aparādhī* (offender) or a *pāṣaṇḍī* (godless man). And because he rejects the things related to Kṛṣṇa that serve the cultivation of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇānuśīlana*), the eternal *svadharma*,[9] he is a *phalgu-vairāgī*, a false renunciant.

Hearing the Lord reviled, the brāhmaṇa remembers Kṛṣṇa and leaves the place —

এত শুনি’ সেই বিপ্র মহাদুঃখ পাইলা ।
‘কৃষ্ণ’ ‘কৃষ্ণ’ কহি’ তথা হৈতে উঠি’ গেলা ॥ ১২২ ॥

eta śuni’ sei vipra mahā-duḥkha pāilā
this hearing that brāhmaṇa great pain felt
‘kṛṣṇa’ ‘kṛṣṇa’ kahi’ tathā haite uṭhi’ gelā
Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa saying there from rising went

122 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa was deeply pained. Saying “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” he rose and left that place.

The brāhmaṇa, his heart purified by seeing the Lord, tells the Lord what happened —

প্রভুর দরশনে শুদ্ধ হঞাছে তাঁর মন ।
প্রভু-আগে দুঃখী হঞা কহে বিবরণ ॥ ১২৩ ॥

prabhura daraśane śuddha hañāche tāṁra mana
of the Lord by the sight pure had become his mind
prabhu-āge duḥkhī hañā kahe vivaraṇa
before the Lord sorrowful being tells the account

123 His mind had been purified by seeing the Lord. Sorrowfully he came before Him and told Him everything.

The Lord's gentle smile —

শুনি' মহাপ্রভু তবে ঈষৎ হাসিলা ।
পুনরপি সেই বিপ্র প্রভুরে পুছিলা ॥ ১২৪ ॥

śuni' mahāprabhu tabe īṣat hāsilā
hearing Mahāprabhu then slightly smiled
punarapi sei vipra prabhure puchilā
again that brāhmaṇa the Lord asked

124 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu smiled slightly, and the brāhmaṇa asked the Lord again:

*By his nature the Māyāvādī is fit to utter only secondary names connected with *prakṛti*, and unfit to utter the name of Vaikuṇṭha, which lies beyond the three states (*turīya*) —*

তার আগে যবে আমি তোমার নাম লইল ।
সেহ তোমার নাম জানে, — আপনে কহিল ॥ ১২৫ ॥

tāra āge yabe āmi tomāra nāma laila
him before when I Your name took
seha tomāra nāma jāne, — āpane kahila
he Your name knows himself said

125 "When I spoke Your name before him, he himself said that he knew Your name.

Anubhāṣya.
His: Prakāśānanda's.

তোমার ‘দোষ’ কহিতে করে নামের উচ্চার ৷
‘চৈতন্য’ ‘চৈতন্য’ করি’ কহে তিনবার ॥ ১২৬ ॥

tomāra ‘doṣa’ kahite kare nāmera uccāra
Your faults in telling makes of the name utterance
‘caitanya’ ‘caitanya’ kari’ kahe tina-bāra
Caitanya Caitanya thus says three times

126 While speaking of Your faults he uttered Your name, saying ‘Caitanya, Caitanya’ three times.

Since the Māyāvādī does not believe in spiritual play, he utters the holy name with contempt; because of this offense to the name, his utterance must not be heard —

তিনবারে ‘কৃষ্ণনাম’ না আইল তার মুখে ৷
‘অবজ্ঞা’তে নাম লয়, শুনি’ পাই দুঃখে ॥ ১২৭ ॥

tina-bāre ‘kṛṣṇa-nāma’ nā āila tāra mukhe
in three times the name of Kṛṣṇa not came his to the mouth
‘avajñā’te nāma laya, śuni’ pāi duḥkhe
with contempt the name he takes hearing I feel pain

127 But not once in those three times did the name of Kṛṣṇa come to his lips. He takes Your name with contempt, and hearing it pains me.

Anubhāṣya.

Doṣa: reviling. Names such as “Brahman,” “Caitanya,” “Ātmā,” “Paramātmā,” “Jagadīśa,” “Īśvara,” “Virāṭ,” “Vibhu,” “Bhūmā,” “Viśvarūpa” and “Vyāpaka,” as the one who utters them understands them, do not point to Kṛṣṇa's magnanimity (*audārya*) or sweetness (*mādhurya*); they point only partly to His majesty (*aiśvarya*). Therefore these names do not reveal that Kṛṣṇa is the embodiment of spiritual *rasa*, as His principal names do. This is why the Māyāvādīs, the worshipers of *prakṛti*, are great offenders. In the end they hold the Truth to be featureless, devoid of spiritual play: they disbelieve and doubt that the Truth's spiritual name, form, qualities, pastimes and distinctive associates are nondual knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*). Nor do they revere Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa's principal names with faith as the sole goal (*sādhya*) and the sole means (*sādhana*). No

one who seeks the eternal, highest good should hear any talk of the highest goal from their mouths.

The brāhmaṇa asks the Lord the reason for this —

ইহার কারণ মোরে কহ কৃপা করি' ।
তোমা দেখি' মুখ মোর বলে 'কৃষ্ণ' 'হরি' ॥" ॥ ১২৮ ॥

ihāra kāraṇa more kaha kṛpā kari'
of this the reason to me tell mercy showing
tomā dekhi' mukha mora bale 'kṛṣṇa' 'hari'"
You seeing mouth my says Kṛṣṇa Hari

128 Please be kind and tell me the reason for this. When I see You, my mouth says 'Kṛṣṇa!' and 'Hari!' "

The Māyāvādī opposes service and is therefore an offender, so Kṛṣṇa's name does not come to his lips —

প্রভু কহে, — মায়াবাদী কৃষ্ণে অপরাধী ।
'ব্রহ্ম', 'আত্মা', 'চৈতন্য' কহে নিরবধি ॥ ১২৯ ॥

prabhu kahe, — māyāvādī kṛṣṇe aparādhī
the Lord says Māyāvādīs to Kṛṣṇa are offenders
'brahma', 'ātmā', 'caitanya' kahe niravadhi
Brahman ātmā caitanya they say incessantly

129 The Lord said, "The Māyāvādīs are offenders against Kṛṣṇa. They incessantly say 'Brahman,' 'ātmā,' 'caitanya' (consciousness).

Anubhāṣya.
Māyāvādī: see Ādi 7.29 and 39.

*Kṛṣṇa's name, form and *svarūpa* are nondual knowledge; a description of how the *jīva's* name, body and *svarūpa* differ —*

অতএব তার মুখে না আইসে কৃষ্ণনাম ।
'কৃষ্ণনাম', 'কৃষ্ণস্বরূপ' — দুইত 'সমান' ॥ ১৩০ ॥

ataeva tāra mukhe nā āise kṛṣṇa-nāma
therefore their to the mouth not comes the name of Kṛṣṇa
'kṛṣṇa-nāma', 'kṛṣṇa-svarūpa' — duita 'samāna'
the name of Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa's own form both are equal

130 Therefore the name of Kṛṣṇa does not come to their lips. The name of Kṛṣṇa and Kṛṣṇa's own form are one and the same.

'নাম', 'বিগ্রহ', 'স্বরূপ' — তিন একরূপ ।
তিনে 'ভেদ' নাহি, — তিন 'চিদানন্দ-রূপ' ॥ ১৩১ ॥

'nāma', 'vigraha', 'svarūpa' — tina eka-rūpa
the name the Deity form the svarūpa the three one in form
tine 'bheda' nāhi, — tina 'cid-ānanda-rūpa'
among the three difference there is not the three are forms of consciousness and bliss

131 The name, the form (*vigraha*) and the essential nature (*svarūpa*) are one. There is no difference among the three: all three are forms of consciousness and bliss.

দেহ-দেহীর, নাম-নামীর কৃষ্ণে নাহি 'ভেদ' ।
জীবের ধর্ম্ম — নাম-দেহ-স্বরূপে 'বিভেদ' ॥ ১৩২ ॥

deha-dehīra, nāma-nāmīra kṛṣṇe nāhi 'bheda'
of body and embodied of name and named in Kṛṣṇa there is not difference
jīvera dharma — nāma-deha-svarūpe 'vibheda'
of the jīva the nature in name body and self difference

132 In Kṛṣṇa there is no difference between the body and its possessor, or between the name and the one named. With the jīva it is otherwise: his name, his body and his true self differ from one another.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Lord said: The Māyāvādī does not accept the *jīva-tattva* as transcendental (*aprākṛta*). He decides that a *jīva* is a fragment of Brahman covered by *māyā*, and since he takes Brahman to be featureless (*nirviśeṣa*), he calls even the (eternal, conscious and blissful) form of Bhagavān "a form made of *māyā*."

For this very reason the Māyāvādī, who considers Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities and pastimes “noneternal,” has become a great offender. Rejecting Kṛṣṇa's “principal names” (*mukhya-nāma*), he utters “secondary names” (*gauṇa-nāma*) such as “Brahman,” “Ātmā” and “Caitanya.” And even if the principal names—“Govinda,” “Mādhava,” “Kṛṣṇa”—sometimes come out of his mouth, the “name” of Kṛṣṇa, the spiritual Form, never comes from his mouth, because his understanding is faulty: he does not believe in Kṛṣṇa's name and takes it for one of the ordinary, worldly words. In truth Kṛṣṇa's name and Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* are both spiritual; that is, the name, the form (*vigraha*) and the *svarūpa* are all three full of spiritual bliss. The body of a conditioned *jīva* is separate from the “embodied one” (*dehī*), the *jīva* himself, and the name his father gave him is separate from his “self,” or *svarūpa*, and depends on matter. But with Kṛṣṇa it is not so: Kṛṣṇa's body is Himself the *dehī*, and Kṛṣṇa's name is Himself the “bearer of the name” (*nāmī*). Since Kṛṣṇa has no connection with *māyā* or with the matter *māyā* produces, a difference between “body and *dehī*” or “name and *nāmī*” is impossible in Him. Only for the conditioned *jīva* do the body and the *dehī*, the name and the *nāmī*, differ; that is, only in the *jīva* do the name, the body and the *svarūpa* have properties separate from one another.

*The nature of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's name — (a statement of the *Padma Purāṇa* and the *Viṣṇu-dharmottara*)*

নাম চিন্তামণিঃ কৃষ্ণশ্চৈতন্যরসবিগ্রহঃ ।
পূর্ণঃ শুদ্ধো নিত্যমুক্তোঽভিন্নত্বান্নামনামিনোঃ ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

nāma cintāmaṇiḥ kṛṣṇaś
the name a wish-fulfilling gem is Kṛṣṇa
caitanya-rasa-vigrahaḥ
of consciousness of rasa the embodiment
pūrṇaḥ śuddho nitya-mukto
complete pure eternally liberated
'bhinnatvān nāma-nāminoḥ
because of non-difference of the name and the named

133 “The name is a wish-fulfilling gem; it is Kṛṣṇa Himself, the embodiment of consciousness and rasa — complete, pure and eternally

liberated, for the name and the named are not different." (Padma Purāṇa; Viṣṇu-dharmottara)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The name of Kṛṣṇa is a special touchstone (*cintāmaṇi*), spiritual by nature. It is Kṛṣṇa, the embodiment of spiritual *rasa*. It is complete, that is, not limited or fragmented like the things of *māyā*. It is pure, that is, unmixed with *māyā*. It is eternally free, that is, always spiritual and never bound by matter—for in their nature the name and the bearer of the name do not differ at all.

Anubhāṣya.

nāma-nāminoḥ (of the name and of the bearer of the name, Kṛṣṇa; that is, of the bearer of the name, Kṛṣṇa, together with the name) **abhinnatvāt** (because there is no difference) (Kṛṣṇa's) **nāma—cintāmaṇiḥ** (the giver of everything desired for service), **kṛṣṇaḥ** (directly Kṛṣṇa Himself in His original form), **caitanya-rasa-vigrahaḥ** (the embodiment of spiritual *rasa*, not the abode of the tastelessness of insentient matter, for it is beyond *māyā* and cannot mix with it), **pūrṇaḥ** (whose form cannot be fragmented by *māyā*), **śuddhaḥ** (unmixed with *māyā*, having cast *māyā* off), **nitya-muktaḥ** (ever beyond matter).

Kṛṣṇa's name, Kṛṣṇa's body and Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are transcendental, spiritual and self-manifest —

অতএব কৃষ্ণের ‘নাম’, ‘দেহ’, ‘বিলাস’ ।
প্রাকৃতেন্দ্রিয়-গ্রাহ্য নহে, হয় স্বপ্রকাশ ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

ataeva kṛṣṇera ‘nāma’, ‘deha’, ‘vilāsa’
therefore Kṛṣṇa’s name body pastimes
prākṛtendriya-grāhya nahe, haya sva-prakāśa
by material senses graspable are not they are self-manifest

134 Therefore Kṛṣṇa’s name, His body and His pastimes cannot be grasped by the material senses; they manifest themselves.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's body, Kṛṣṇa's name, Kṛṣṇa's form, Kṛṣṇa's qualities, Kṛṣṇa's pastimes—the distinctive features of His associates—and the rest are full of eternity, knowledge and bliss. Therefore a *jīva* who identifies with the three modes, *sattva* and the

others, cannot perceive them as material form, taste, smell, sound or touch; that is, they are not objects of enjoyment for the *jīva's* senses, which crave to enjoy fruits. All of them are self-manifest reality (*svataḥ-prakāśa-vastu*), eternal, spiritual and blissful. Material things, which fall under the modes, have name, form, qualities and actions that differ from one another materially; there is no oneness among them. But in Kṛṣṇa, Adhokṣaja (He who is beyond the senses), there is no such "difference."

Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities and pastimes are one and the same reality —

'কৃষ্ণনাম', 'কৃষ্ণগুণ', 'কৃষ্ণলীলা'-বৃন্দ ।
কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ সম, — সব চিদানন্দ ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

'kṛṣṇa-nāma', 'kṛṣṇa-guṇa', 'kṛṣṇa-līlā'-vṛnda
Kṛṣṇa's name Kṛṣṇa's qualities Kṛṣṇa's pastimes all
kṛṣṇera svarūpa sama, — saba cid-ānanda
Kṛṣṇa's svarūpa equal to all consciousness and bliss

135 Kṛṣṇa's name, His qualities and all His pastimes are equal to Kṛṣṇa's own form: all of them are consciousness and bliss.

*Kṛṣṇa's transcendental name, form, qualities and pastimes are grasped only by pure devotion; by the path of argument, by knowledge born of the senses, they cannot be reached — (a statement of the *Padma Purāṇa*)*

অতঃ শ্রীকৃষ্ণনামাদি ন ভবেদ্গ্রাহ্যমিন্দ্রিয়ৈঃ ।
সেবোন্মুখে হি জিহ্বাদৌ স্বয়মেব স্ফুরত্যদঃ ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

ataḥ śrī-kṛṣṇa-nāmādi
therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa's name and the rest
na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiḥ
not can be grasped by the senses
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau
when turned toward service indeed on the tongue and the rest
svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ
of itself alone manifests this

136 “Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s name, form, qualities and pastimes cannot be grasped by the material senses. When one is turned toward service, they reveal themselves of their own accord, beginning on the tongue.” (Padma Purāṇa; cited in Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.234)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Therefore the name, form, qualities and pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa are never perceived by worldly eyes, ears and other senses. When the *jīva* turns toward service (*sevonmukha*), that is, turns toward Kṛṣṇa in his spiritual nature, then Kṛṣṇa's name and the rest manifest of Themselves in his transcendental senses—the tongue and the others.

Anubhāṣya.

ataḥ (because Kṛṣṇa's name and the rest have no mundane difference from Kṛṣṇa Himself) **śrī-kṛṣṇa-nāmādi** (Śrī Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities, pastimes and the distinctive features of His associates) **indriyaiḥ** (by the material senses bent on enjoyment—eyes, ears, nose, tongue, skin and the others) **grāhyam** (made an object of form, sound, smell, taste, touch and so on) **na bhavet** (never becomes). (If one objects, “Since it is Adhokṣaja, it is wholly beyond the reach of senses that crave material enjoyment; how then, and by what kind of *jīvas*, can shelter be taken in it?”—to this he says:) **sevonmukhe** (inclined, with transcendental intelligence, to pure service to Kṛṣṇa) **jihvādau** (in the tongue and the others—in senses made of *śuddha-sattva*) **hi** (indeed) **adaḥ** (Kṛṣṇa's name and the rest) **svayam eva sphurati** (manifests by itself).

Kṛṣṇa's supremely wondrous sweetness attracts even the knower of Brahman

—

ব্রহ্মানন্দ হৈতে পূর্ণানন্দ লীলারস ।
ব্রহ্মজ্ঞানী আকর্ষিয়া করে আত্মবশ ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

brahmānanda haite pūrṇānanda līlā-rasa
than the bliss of Brahman more than full bliss of the pastimes the rasa
brahma-jñānī ākarṣiyā kare ātma-vaśa
the knower of Brahman attracting makes subject to itself

137 The rasa of His pastimes is fuller bliss than the bliss of Brahman. It attracts even the knower of Brahman and makes him its own.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In those in whom the thought “I am Brahman” arises, thoughts of *māyā* fall away, and a little happiness does arise in them: abiding in spiritual Brahman. But those who can awaken in their hearts the spiritual play of *rasa*—Kṛṣṇa's name, Kṛṣṇa's form, Kṛṣṇa's qualities and Kṛṣṇa's pastimes—taste the *rasa* of pastimes full of bliss, infinitely superior to “the bliss of Brahman.” Therefore Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, the very *rasa* of pastimes full of bliss, suddenly attract the knower of Brahman and bring him under their sway.

*Brahmarāta, a knower of Brahman, attracted by the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 12, ch. 12, verse 69)*

স্বসুখনিভৃতচেতাস্তদ্ব্যুদস্তান্যভাবো-
ঽপ্যজিতরুচিরলীলাকৃষ্টসারস্তদীয়ম্ ।
ব্যতনুত কৃপয়া যস্তত্ত্বদীপং পুরাণং
তমখিলবৃজিনঘ্নং ব্যাসসূনুং নতোঽস্মি ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

sva-sukha-nibhṛta-cetās tad vyudastānya-bhāvo
in his own happiness filled whose mind therefore having cast off other feelings

'py ajita-rucira-līlākṛṣṭa-sāras tadīyam
yet by the Unconquerable One's charming pastimes attracted whose heart about Him

vyatanuta kṛpayā yas tattva-dīpaṁ purāṇaṁ
composed out of mercy who of the truth the lamp the Purāṇa

tam akhila-vṛjina-ghnaṁ vyāsa-sūnuṁ nato 'smi
to him of all sins the destroyer to the son of Vyāsa bowed am I

138 “His mind was filled with the happiness of the self, and so he had cast off every other feeling; yet his heart was drawn by the charming pastimes of the Unconquerable Lord, and in his mercy he brought forth the lamp of truth, the Purāṇa that tells of Him. To him, the son of Vyāsa, destroyer of all sins, I bow down.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 12.12.69)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

At first his heart was absorbed in the happiness of Brahman; later he gave that happiness up, was drawn by Kṛṣṇa's pastimes full of sweetness, and set forth the

Śrīmad-Bhāgavata Purāṇa, the lamp of truth about Kṛṣṇa. To that *guru*, the destroyer of all sins, Śrī Śuka, the son of Vyāsa, I bow.

Anubhāṣya.

Having finished narrating the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* to the sages headed by Śaunaka, who longed to hear, the *mahā-bhāgavata* Śrī Sūta Gosvāmī bows to his *guru* Brahmarāta, Śrīla Śuka Gosvāmī:

sva-sukha-nibhṛta-cetāḥ (he whose heart was filled with the happiness of his own self, that is, an *ātmārāma*) **tad-vyudastānya-bhāvaḥ** (he in whom, by that very state of an *ātmārāma*, every "other feeling"—attachment [*rati*] to anything besides Brahman—had been fully removed) **api ajita-rucira-līlākṛṣṭa-sāraḥ** (he whose steadiness [*sāra*], resting on the happiness of his own self, was drawn away by the charming pastimes of Ajita, Kṛṣṇa) **yaḥ tattva-dīpaṁ** (the lamp that reveals the reality of the highest goal) **tadīyam** (full of Bhagavān's pastimes) **purāṇaṁ** (the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, a work marked by the ten characteristics) **kṛpayā** (out of compassion for people who do not know, for their good, or wishing good for those who have *sukṛti*) **vyatanuta** (manifested), **tam akhila-vṛjina-ghnaṁ** (the dispeller of all sins) **vyāsa-sūnuṁ** (the son of Dvaipāyana, Vaiyāsaki —Śukadeva) **nataḥ asmi** (I bow).

*Kṛṣṇa's supremely wondrous qualities attract even the *ātmārāmas* —*

ব্রহ্মানন্দ হৈতে পূর্ণানন্দ কৃষ্ণগুণ ।
অতএব আকর্ষয়ে আত্মারামের মন ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

brahmānanda haite pūrṇānanda kṛṣṇa-guṇa
than the bliss of Brahman more than full bliss are Kṛṣṇa's qualities
ataeva ākarṣaye ātmārāmera mana
therefore they attract of the ātmārāma the mind

139 Kṛṣṇa's qualities are fuller bliss than the bliss of Brahman. Therefore they attract the mind even of one who delights in the self.

*Even liberated souls are wholly drawn to Kṛṣṇa's feet — (*Śrīmad-*

Bhāgavatam, Canto 1, ch. 7, verse 10)*

আত্মারামাশ্চ মুনয়ো নির্গ্রন্থা অপ্যুরুক্রমে ।
কুর্ব্বন্ত্যহৈতুকীং ভক্তিমিত্থম্ভূতগুণো হরিঃ ॥ ১৪০ ॥

ātmārāmāś ca munayo
delighting in the ātmā and the sages
nirgranthā apy urukrame
free from knots even to Urukrama
kurvanty ahaitukīṁ bhaktim
perform causeless devotion
ittham-bhūta-guṇo hariḥ
of such qualities is Hari

140 "Even sages who delight in the ātmā and are free from the knots of the heart render causeless devotion to Urukrama, for such are the qualities of Hari." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.7.10)[5]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 6.186.

*The *tulasī* from Kṛṣṇa's feet captivates the minds even of the knowers of Brahman —*

এই সব রহু — কৃষ্ণচরণ-সম্বন্ধে ।
আত্মারামের মন হরে তুলসীর গন্ধে ॥ ১৪১ ॥

ei saba rahu — kṛṣṇa-caraṇa-sambandhe
these all let them be with Kṛṣṇa's feet in connection
ātmārāmera mana hare tulasīra gandhe
of the ātmārāma the mind steals of tulasī the fragrance

141 But leave all this aside: the very fragrance of tulasī that has touched Kṛṣṇa's feet steals the mind of one who delights in the self.

*The *tulasī* from Nārāyaṇa's feet produces pure *sāttvika* transformations in the body and mind even of the four Sanas, knowers of Brahman — (*Śrīmad-*

Bhāgavatam, Canto 3, ch. 15, verse 43)*

তস্যারবিন্দনয়নস্য পদারবিন্দ-
কিঞ্জল্কমিশ্রতুলসীমকরন্দবায়ুঃ ।
অন্তর্গতঃ স্ববিবরেণ চকার তেষাং
সংক্ষোভমক্ষরজুষামপি চিত্ততন্বোঃ ॥ ১৪২ ॥

tasyāravinda-nayanasya padāravinda-
of Him the lotus-eyed of the lotus feet
kiñjalka-miśra-tulasī-makaranda-vāyuḥ
with the filaments mixed of tulasī of the nectar the breeze
antar-gataḥ sva-vivareṇa cakāra teṣāṁ
having entered within through its own passage caused in them
saṅkṣobham akṣara-juṣām api citta-tanvoḥ
agitation devoted to the imperishable Brahman even of mind and body

142 "The breeze that bore the fragrance of tulasī, mingled with the pollen of the lotus-eyed Lord's lotus feet, entered their nostrils and stirred both their minds and their bodies, though they were devoted to the imperishable Brahman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.15.43)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The breeze, laden with the honeyed fragrance of the *tulasī* mixed with the filaments of the lotus feet of the lotus-eyed Bhagavān, entered through the nostrils of the four Sanas, who were devoted to the featureless Brahman, and stirred their minds and bodies.

Anubhāṣya.
The dialogue of Maitreya and Vidura. The demigods were terrified by the power of the child in Diti's womb, and Brahmā tells them the background of the two *asuras* she carries. Once, long ago, the *brahmarṣis*—the four Sanas, or Kumāras—wished to see Śrī Nārāyaṇa and entered Vaikuṇṭha, but at the seventh gate the two doorkeepers named Jaya and Vijaya stopped them. Then the Kumāras, in anger driven by the urge to violence that is born of a sense of difference, cursed them to take birth in the wombs of *asuras*. The all-knowing Bhagavān Padmanābha learned of this and at once came there Himself with Lakṣmī. The *ṛṣis* saw before them the One they worshiped, Bhagavān Nārāyaṇa Himself, the

fruit of their *brahma-samādhi*, and bowed down. The verse describes the transformations of feeling in these *ātmārāmas*, knowers of Brahman:

aravinda-nayanasya (of the lotus-eyed) **tasya** (of that Bhagavān) **padāravinda-kiñjalka-miśra-tulasī-makaranda-vāyuḥ** (the breeze carrying the nectar of the *tulasī* mixed with the filaments [*keśara*] of His lotus feet) **sva-vivareṇa** (through their nostrils) **antar-gataḥ** (having entered within) **akṣara-juṣām** (devoted to the featureless Brahman) **api teṣāṁ** (of those Kumāras, Sanaka and the others) **citta-tanvoḥ** (in mind and body) **saṅkṣobham** (in the mind, rapture; in the body, hair standing on end and the like) **cakāra** (produced).

The Māyāvādī opposes eternal service to Kṛṣṇa and is therefore unfit to chant the pure name —

অতএব ‘কৃষ্ণনাম’ না আইসে তার মুখে ৷
মায়াবাদি-গণ, যাতে মহা-বহির্ম্মুখে ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

ataeva ‘kṛṣṇa-nāma’ nā āise tāra mukhe
therefore the name of Kṛṣṇa not comes their to the mouth
māyāvādi-gaṇa, yāte mahā-bahirmukhe
the Māyāvādīs since are utterly averse

143 Therefore the name of Kṛṣṇa does not come to the lips of the Māyāvādīs, for they are utterly averse to the Lord.

*The Lord came to flood Kāśī with a deluge of *prema* —*

ভাবকালি বেচিতে আমি আইলাঙ কাশীপুরে ৷
গ্রাহক নাহি, না বিকায়, লঞা যাব ঘরে ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

bhāvakāli vecite āmi āilāṅa kāśīpure
wares of emotion to sell I came to Kāśī
grāhaka nāhi, nā vikāya, lañā yāba ghare
buyer there is none not it sells taking it I shall go home

144 I came to Kāśī to sell My wares of emotion, but there is no buyer; they do not sell, so I shall have to take them back home.

*The Lord promises to give out *prema* for a single price—eager longing (*laulya*) —*

ভারি বোঝা লঞা আইলাঙ, কেমনে লঞা যাব ?
অল্প-স্বল্প-মূল্য পাইলে, এথাই বেচিব ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

bhāri bojhā lañā āilāṅa, kemane lañā yāba?
heavy load bringing I came how taking it shall I go
alpa-svalpa-mūlya pāile, ethāi veciba
a small a trifling price if I get right here I shall sell

145 I came with a heavy load — how can I carry it back? If I get even a small price, I will sell it right here."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
(The vessel of the spiritual *rasa* of the name) is a very heavy load; I sell it to the *jīvas* for the price of full faith (*śraddhā*). It is very hard for a merchant to carry such a heavy load back home. So if I get even a small price—that is, the price of a semblance of faith (*śraddhābhāsa*)—I will sell it here.

Anubhāṣya.
The small price is eager longing (*laulya*)—greed (*lobha*), or taste (*ruci*)—for service to Kṛṣṇa; it cannot be gained without self-surrender. The verse of the *Padyāvalī* quoted at Madhya 8.70 should be considered here.

Having shown mercy to the brāhmaṇa, the Lord sets out for Mathurā —

এত বলি' সেই বিপ্রে আত্মসাৎ করি' ।
প্রাতে উঠি' মথুরা চলিলা গৌরহরি ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

eta bali' sei vipre ātmasāt kari'
thus saying that brāhmaṇa His own making
prāte uṭhi' mathurā calilā gaurahari
in the morning rising to Mathurā set out Gaurahari

146 Saying this, Gaurahari made that brāhmaṇa His own, and rising early the next morning He set out for Mathurā.

The three follow the Lord and, at His insistence, return —

সেই তিন সঙ্গে চলে, প্রভু নিষেধিল ।
দূর হৈতে তিনজনে ঘরে পাঠাইল ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

sei tina saṅge cale, prabhu niṣedhila
those three with Him go the Lord forbade
dūra haite tina-jane ghare pāṭhāila
from a distance from the three home He sent

147 Those three followed Him, but the Lord forbade them, and from some way along the road He sent all three back home.

The three sing the Lord's qualities together —

প্রভুর বিরহে তিনে একত্র মিলিয়া ।
প্রভুগুণ গান করে প্রেমে মত্ত হঞা ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

prabhura virahe tine ekatra miliyā
of the Lord in separation the three together meeting
prabhu-guṇa gāna kare preme matta hañā
the Lord's qualities singing do with love maddened becoming

148 In separation from the Lord the three would meet together and sing of His qualities, maddened with love.

*Coming to Prayāga and bathing, the Lord dances and sings *kīrtana* on seeing Bindu-mādhava[10] —*

'প্রয়াগ' আসিয়া প্রভু কৈল নদীস্নান ।
'মাধব' দেখিয়া প্রেমে কৈল নৃত্যগান ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

'prayāga' āsiyā prabhu kaila nadī-snāna
to Prayāga coming the Lord performed bathing in the river
'mādhava' dekhiyā preme kaila nṛtya-gāna
Mādhava seeing in love performed dancing and singing

149 Coming to Prayāga, the Lord bathed in the river, and on seeing Mādhava He danced and sang in love.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mādhava: Veṇī-mādhava.

Anubhāṣya.
Prayāga: "that from which comes the excellent (*prakṛṣṭa*) sacrifice (*yāga*), the fruit of sacrifices." It is the king of *tīrthas*, the confluence of the Gaṅgā and the Yamunā, or Triveṇī. Not far from the present Allahabad fort lies ancient Pratiṣṭhānapura, the present Jhusi.

The Yamunā awakens in the Lord the memory of the pastimes of Vraja, and He leaps into the water; the Bhaṭṭācārya pulls Him out —

যমুনা দেখিয়া প্রেমে পড়ে ঝাঁপ দিয়া ।
আস্তে ব্যস্তে ভট্টাচার্য্য উঠায় ধরিয়া ॥ ১৫০ ॥

yamunā dekhiyā preme paḍe jhāṁpa diyā
the Yamunā seeing in love He falls a leap making
āste vyaste bhaṭṭācārya uṭhāya dhariyā
hastily hurriedly the Bhaṭṭācārya lifts Him up catching hold

150 Seeing the Yamunā, He leapt into it in love, and the Bhaṭṭācārya hurriedly caught hold of Him and lifted Him out.

For three days in Prayāga the Lord delivers the people —

এইমত তিনদিন প্রয়াগে রহিলা ।
কৃষ্ণ-নাম-প্রেম দিয়া লোক নিস্তারিলা ॥ ১৫১ ॥

ei-mata tina-dina prayāge rahilā
in this way three days in Prayāga He stayed
kṛṣṇa-nāma-prema diyā loka nistārilā
Kṛṣṇa's name and love giving the people He delivered

151 In this way He stayed three days in Prayāga, delivering the people by giving them the name of Kṛṣṇa and love for Him.

The Lord delivers people on the way to Mathurā —

‘মথুরা’ চলিতে পথে যথা রহি’ যায় ।
কৃষ্ণ-নাম-প্রেম দিয়া লোকেরে নাচায় ॥ ১৫২ ॥

‘mathurā’ calite pathe yathā rahi’ yāya
to Mathurā going on the way wherever stopping He goes
kṛṣṇa-nāma-prema diyā lokere nācāya
Kṛṣṇa’s name and love giving the people He makes dance

152 Wherever He stopped on the way to Mathurā, He gave the people the name of Kṛṣṇa and love for Him and made them dance.

As He did the southern country before, the Lord delivers the United Provinces too —

পূর্ব্বে যেন ‘দক্ষিণ’ যাইতে লোক নিস্তারিলা ।
‘পশ্চিম’-দেশে তৈছে সব ‘বৈষ্ণব’ করিলা ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

pūrve yena ‘dakṣiṇa’ yāite loka nistārilā
before as south going the people He delivered
‘paścima’-deśe taiche saba ‘vaiṣṇava’ karilā
in the western lands likewise all Vaiṣṇavas He made

153 As He had delivered the people before when He went to the south, so in the western lands He made everyone a Vaiṣṇava.

As soon as He sees the Yamunā, the Lord leaps into it —

পথে যাঁহা যাঁহা হয় যমুনা-দর্শন ।
তাঁহা ঝাঁপ দিয়া পড়ে প্রেমে অচেতন ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

pathe yāṁhā yāṁhā haya yamunā-darśana
on the way wherever wherever there was a sight of the Yamunā
tāṁhā jhāṁpa diyā paḍe preme acetana
there a leap making He falls in love unconscious

154 Wherever He caught sight of the Yamunā along the way, He leapt into it and fell unconscious in love.

*At the sight of Mathurā the Lord is overwhelmed by *prema* —*

মথুরা-নিকটে আইলা, মথুরা দেখিয়া ।
দণ্ডবৎ হঞা পড়ে প্রেমাবিষ্ট হঞা ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

mathurā-nikaṭe āilā, mathurā dekhiyā
near Mathurā He came Mathurā seeing
daṇḍavat hañā paḍe premāviṣṭa hañā
like a rod becoming He falls absorbed in love being

155 When He drew near Mathurā and saw the city, He fell down flat like a rod, overwhelmed with love.

*Bathing at Viśrāma-ghāṭa and *darśana* of Keśava at the Yogapīṭha —*

মথুরা আসিয়া কৈলা, 'বিশ্রাম-তীর্থে' স্নান ।
'জন্মস্থানে' 'কেশব' দেখি' করিলা প্রণাম ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

mathurā āsiyā kailā, 'viśrāma-tīrthe' snāna
to Mathurā coming He performed at Viśrāma-tīrtha bathing
'janma-sthāne' 'keśava' dekhi' karilā praṇāma
at the birthplace Keśava seeing He offered obeisance

156 Arriving in Mathurā, He bathed at Viśrāma-tīrtha, and at the birthplace He saw Keśava and bowed down to Him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Viśrāma-tīrtha: the famous Viśrāma-ghāṭa. "Keśava at the birthplace": the Deity of Śrī Keśavajī at Śrī Kṛṣṇa's birthplace.

*The people are amazed to see the Lord overwhelmed by *prema* —*

প্রেমাবেশে নাচে, গায়, সঘনে হুঙ্কার ।
প্রভুর প্রেমাবেশ দেখি' লোকে চমৎকার ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

premāveśe nāce, gāya, saghane huṅkāra
in the rapture of love He dances sings again and again roars
prabhura premāveśa dekhi' loke camatkāra
the Lord's rapture of love seeing the people are astonished

157 Rapt in love, He danced, sang and roared again and again, and the people were astonished to see the Lord's rapture of love.

*A brāhmaṇa, following the Lord, dances and sings in the ecstasy of *prema* —*

একবিপ্র পড়ে প্রভুর চরণ ধরিয়া ।
প্রভু-সঙ্গে নৃত্য করে প্রেমাবিষ্ট হঞা ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

eka-vipra paḍe prabhura caraṇa dhariyā
a brāhmaṇa falls the Lord's feet clasping
prabhu-saṅge nṛtya kare premāviṣṭa hañā
with the Lord dancing does absorbed in love becoming

158 A brāhmaṇa fell down and clasped the Lord's feet, and then, overwhelmed with love, he danced with the Lord.

*Both dance and sing *kīrtana* —*

দুঁহে প্রেমে নৃত্য করি' করে কোলাকুলি ।
'হরি' 'কৃষ্ণ' কহে দুঁহে বলি' বাহু তুলি ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

duṁhe preme nṛtya kari' kare kolākuli
both in love dancing doing they make embraces
'hari' 'kṛṣṇa' kahe duṁhe bali' bāhu tuli
Hari Kṛṣṇa say both saying arms raising

159 Dancing in love, the two embraced each other, and with arms raised they both called out, "Hari! Kṛṣṇa!"

*The crowd's tumult; the *pūjārī* puts a garland around the Lord's neck —*

লোক 'হরি' 'হরি' বলে, কোলাহল হৈল ।
'কেশব'-সেবক প্রভুকে মালা পরাইল ॥ ১৬০ ॥

loka 'hari' 'hari' bale, kolāhala haila
the people Hari Hari say a tumult arose
'keśava'-sevaka prabhuke mālā parāila
Keśava's servant on the Lord a garland placed

160 The people cried, “Hari! Hari!” and a great tumult arose. Keśava’s servant placed a garland on the Lord.

*The people are convinced that the Lord's *prema* is “not of this world” —*

লোকে কহে প্রভু দেখি’ হঞা বিস্ময়।
ঐছে হেন প্রেম ‘লৌকিক’ কভু নয় ॥ ১৬১ ॥

loke kahe prabhu dekhi’ hañā vismaya
the people say the Lord seeing becoming astonished
aiche hena prema ‘laukika’ kabhu naya
such this kind of love worldly ever is not

161 Seeing the Lord, the people were amazed and said, “Love such as this is never of this world.

The reason it is not of this world is shown —

যাঁহার দর্শনে লোকে প্রেমে মত্ত হঞা।
হাসে, কান্দে, নাচে, গায়, কৃষ্ণনাম লঞা ॥ ১৬২ ॥

yāṁhāra darśane loke preme matta hañā
whose at the sight the people with love maddened becoming
hāse, kānde, nāce, gāya, kṛṣṇa-nāma lañā
laugh weep dance sing the name of Kṛṣṇa taking

162 At the sight of Him people become mad with love: they laugh, weep, dance and sing, chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa.

A firm conclusion —

সর্ব্বথা নিশ্চিত, ইঁহো — কৃষ্ণ-অবতার।
মথুরা আইল লোকের করিতে নিস্তার ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

sarvathā niścita, iṁho — kṛṣṇa-avatāra
in every way certain He is an avatāra of Kṛṣṇa
mathurā āila lokera karite nistāra
to Mathurā He has come of the people to accomplish deliverance

163 It is certain in every way that He is an avatāra of Kṛṣṇa. He has come to Mathurā to deliver the people."

*Seeing that brāhmaṇa's *prema*, the Lord asks him about himself —*

তবে মহাপ্রভু সেই ব্রাহ্মণে লঞা ।
তাঁহারে পুছিলা কিছু নিভৃতে বসিয়া ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

tabe mahāprabhu sei brāhmaṇe lañā
then Mahāprabhu that brāhmaṇa taking
tāṁhāre puchilā kichu nibhṛte vasiyā
him asked something in private sitting

164 Then Mahāprabhu took that brāhmaṇa aside, sat with him in private and asked him:

'আর্য্য, সরল তুমি — বৃদ্ধ ব্রাহ্মণ ।
কাঁহা হৈতে পাইলে তুমি এই প্রেমধন ? ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

'ārya, sarala tumi — vṛddha brāhmaṇa
noble simple you are an aged brāhmaṇa
kāṁhā haite pāile tumi ei prema-dhana?
where from did you get you this treasure of love

165 "You are noble and simple-hearted, an aged brāhmaṇa. Where did you get this treasure of love?"

*The brāhmaṇa tells of his *guru*, Śrī Mādhavendra —*

বিপ্র কহে, — শ্রীপাদ মাধবেন্দ্র-পুরী ।
ভ্রমিতে ভ্রমিতে আইলা মথুরা-নগরী ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

vipra kahe, — śrīpāda mādhavendra-purī
the brāhmaṇa says Śrīpāda Mādhavendra Purī
bhramite bhramite āilā mathurā-nagarī
wandering wandering came to the city of Mathurā

166 The brāhmaṇa said, “Śrīpāda Mādhavendra Purī came to the city of Mathurā in the course of his wanderings.

কৃপা করি’ তেঁহো মোর নিলয়ে আইলা ।
মোরে শিষ্য করি’ মোর হাতে ‘ভিক্ষা’ কৈলা ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

kṛpā kari’ teṁho mora nilaye āilā
mercy showing he my to the dwelling came
more śiṣya kari’ mora hāte ‘bhikṣā’ kailā
me a disciple making from my hands alms he took

167 Out of kindness he came to my home. He made me his disciple and accepted his meal (*bhikṣā*) from my hands.

গোপাল প্রকট করি’ সেবা কৈল ‘মহাশয়’ ।
অদ্যাপিহ তাঁহার সেবা ‘গোবর্দ্ধনে’ হয় ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

gopāla prakaṭa kari’ sevā kaila ‘mahāśaya’
Gopāla manifest making service performed the great soul
adyāpiha tāṁhāra sevā ‘govardhane’ haya
to this day His service at Govardhana goes on

168 That great soul brought Gopāla to light and served Him, and to this day Gopāla is served at Govardhana.”

*Honoring the brāhmaṇa as His *guru*, the Lord bows at his feet; in fear and reverence the brāhmaṇa bows to the Lord —*

শুনি’ প্রভু কৈল তাঁর চরণ বন্দন ।
ভয় পাঞা প্রভু-পায় পড়িলা ব্রাহ্মণ ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

śuni’ prabhu kaila tāṁra caraṇa vandana
hearing the Lord made his to the feet obeisance
bhaya pāñā prabhu-pāya paḍilā brāhmaṇa
fear feeling at the Lord’s feet fell the brāhmaṇa

169 Hearing this, the Lord bowed down at the brāhmaṇa's feet, and the brāhmaṇa in fear fell at the Lord's feet.

*The Lord, the guardian of propriety (*maryādā*), shows humility before His *guru* —*

প্রভু কহে, — তুমি 'গুরু', আমি 'শিষ্য'-প্রায় ।
'গুরু' হঞা, 'শিষ্যে' নমস্কার না যুয়ায় ॥ ১৭০ ॥

prabhu kahe, — tumi 'guru', āmi 'śiṣya'-prāya
the Lord says you are guru I like a disciple
'guru' hañā, 'śiṣye' namaskāra nā yuyāya
guru being to a disciple obeisance not is proper

170 The Lord said, "You are in the position of a guru, and I am like your disciple. It is not proper for a guru to bow down to a disciple."

The brāhmaṇa expresses fear and humility —

শুনিয়া বিস্মিত বিপ্র কহে ভয় পাঞা ।
ঐছে বাত্ কহ কেনে সন্ন্যাসী হঞা ॥ ১৭১ ॥

śuniyā vismita vipra kahe bhaya pāñā
hearing astonished the brāhmaṇa says fear feeling
aiche bāt kaha kene sannyāsī hañā
such words You speak why a sannyāsī being

171 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa was astonished and said in fear, "You are a *sannyāsī* — why do You speak like this?

The brāhmaṇa infers that the Lord is connected with Mādhavendra —

কিন্তু তোমার প্রেম দেখি' মনে অনুমানি ।
মাধবেন্দ্র-পুরীর 'সম্বন্ধ' ধর, জানি ॥ ১৭২ ॥

kintu tomāra prema dekhi' mane anumāni
but Your love seeing in my mind I infer
mādhavendra-purīra 'sambandha' dhara, jāni
with Mādhavendra Purī a connection You have I know

172 But seeing Your love, I infer that You have some connection with Mādhavendra Purī; I am sure of it.

*Without connection with Mādhavendra, *kṛṣṇa-prema* is nowhere to be had —*

কৃষ্ণপ্রেমা তাঁহা, যাঁহা তাঁহার 'সম্বন্ধ' ।
তাঁহা বিনা এই প্রেমার কাঁহা নাহি গন্ধ ॥ ১৭৩ ॥

kṛṣṇa-premā tāṁhā, yāṁhā tāṁhāra 'sambandha'
love for Kṛṣṇa is there where his connection
tāṁhā vinā ei premāra kāṁhā nāhi gandha
him without of this love anywhere there is not the scent

173 Love for Kṛṣṇa is found where there is a connection with him. Without him there is not even a scent of such love anywhere."

*The Bhaṭṭācārya tells who the Lord's *guru* is —*

তবে ভট্টাচার্য্য তারে 'সম্বন্ধ' কহিল ।
শুনি' আনন্দিত বিপ্র নাচিতে লাগিল ॥ ১৭৪ ॥

tabe bhaṭṭācārya tāre 'sambandha' kahila
then the Bhaṭṭācārya to him the connection told
śuni' ānandita vipra nācite lāgila
hearing overjoyed the brāhmaṇa to dance began

174 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya told him of the connection, and hearing it the brāhmaṇa began to dance with joy.

Anubhāṣya.
Earlier, in Pāṇḍarapura, Śrī Raṅga Purī too said something similar to the Lord; see Madhya 9.289 and 291.

The brāhmaṇa brings the Lord to his home and serves Him —

তবে বিপ্র প্রভুরে লঞা আইলা নিজ-ঘরে ।
আপন-ইচ্ছায় প্রভুর নানা সেবা করে ॥ ১৭৫ ॥

tabe vipra prabhure lañā āilā nija-ghare
then the brāhmaṇa the Lord taking came to his own home
āpana-icchāya prabhura nānā sevā kare
of his own accord for the Lord various service does

175 Then the brāhmaṇa took the Lord to his own home and of his own accord rendered Him many kinds of service.

*In humility the brāhmaṇa has the Bhaṭṭācārya cook; the Lord, who upholds the *daiva-varṇāśrama-dharma* favorable to pure *bhakti*, reveals the true meaning of the scriptures and so teaches the people —*

ভিক্ষা লাগি' ভট্টাচার্য্যে করাইল রন্ধন ।
তবে মহাপ্রভু হাসি' বলিলা বচন ॥ ১৭৬ ॥

bhikṣā lāgi' bhaṭṭācārye karāila randhana
the meal for the sake of the Bhaṭṭācārya he had cook
tabe mahāprabhu hāsi' balilā vacana
then Mahāprabhu smiling spoke words

176 He had the Bhaṭṭācārya cook for the Lord's meal, but Mahāprabhu smiled and said:

The Lord wishes to take His meal in the home of the brāhmaṇa who received Purī's mercy —

পুরী-গোসাঞি তোমার ঘরে কর্য্যাছেন ভিক্ষা ।
মোরে তুমি ভিক্ষা দেহ', — এই মোর 'শিক্ষা' ॥ ১৭৭ ॥

"purī-gosāñi tomāra ghare karyāchena bhikṣā
Purī Gosāñi your in the house has taken alms
more tumi bhikṣā deha', — ei mora 'śikṣā'"
to Me you alms give this My teaching

177 “Purī Gosāñi has taken his meals in your house. You yourself give Me My meal — this is My instruction.

*The conduct of the *ācārya* is the standard for the people — (*Bhagavad-gītā*, ch. 3, verse 21)*

যদ্যদাচরতি শ্রেষ্ঠস্তত্তদেবেতরো জনঃ ।
স যৎ প্রমাণং কুরুতে লোকস্তদনুবর্ত্ততে ॥ ১৭৮ ॥

yad yad ācarati śreṣṭhas
whatever whatever does the best
tat tad evetaro janaḥ
that that indeed other people
sa yat pramāṇaṁ kurute
he whatever standard sets
lokas tad anuvartate
the world that follows

178 “Whatever the best of men does, others do the same; whatever standard he sets, the world follows.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 3.21)[6]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.25.

*Because of his family by birth (*śaukra*), that brāhmaṇa's food is not accepted —*

যদ্যপি ‘সনোড়িয়া’ হয় সেইত ব্রাহ্মণ ।
সনোড়িয়া-ঘরে সন্ন্যাসী না করে ভোজন ॥ ১৭৯ ॥

yadyapi ‘sanoḍiyā’ haya seita brāhmaṇa
although a Sanoḍiyā was that very brāhmaṇa
sanoḍiyā-ghare sannyāsī nā kare bhojana
in a Sanoḍiyā’s house a sannyāsī not does eat

179 That brāhmaṇa was a Sanoḍiyā, and *sannyāsīs* do not eat in a Sanoḍiyā’s house.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the western country the *vaiśyas* are divided into several groups: the "Agarwāla," the "Kalwār," the "Sānoyāṛ" and others. Of these the Agarwālas are the purest, while the Kalwārs, Sānoyāṛs and other classes have fallen through the faults of their own occupations. Those who serve as priests (*yājana*) for these Kalwārs and Sānoyāṛs are called "Sānoḍiyā brāhmaṇas" and so on. The word "Sānoyāṛ" means "gold merchant" (*suvarṇa-vaṇik*), and the brāhmaṇas who serve them as priests are the "Sānoḍiyā (*varṇa*-) brāhmaṇas." Since these brāhmaṇas have fallen through the fault of such priestly service, *sannyāsīs* do not eat in their homes.

Recognizing him as a Vaiṣṇava, that is, a pure brāhmaṇa, Purī accepts him as a disciple —

তথাপি পুরী দেখি' তাঁর 'বৈষ্ণব'-আচার ।
'শিষ্য' করি' তাঁর ভিক্ষা কৈল অঙ্গীকার ॥ ১৮০ ॥

tathāpi purī dekhi' tāṁra 'vaiṣṇava'-ācāra
nevertheless Purī seeing his Vaiṣṇava conduct
'śiṣya' kari' tāṁra bhikṣā kaila aṅgīkāra
a disciple making him his meal made acceptance

180 Nevertheless, seeing his Vaiṣṇava conduct, Purī made him his disciple and accepted meals from him.

Hearing that the Lord wishes to eat in his home, the brāhmaṇa speaks in humility —

মহাপ্রভু তাঁরে যদি 'ভিক্ষা' মাগিল ।
দৈন্য করি' সেই বিপ্র কহিতে লাগিল ॥ ১৮১ ॥

mahāprabhu tāṁre yadi 'bhikṣā' māgila
Mahāprabhu of him when a meal asked
dainya kari' sei vipra kahite lāgila
humility showing that brāhmaṇa to speak began

181 When Mahāprabhu asked him for a meal, the brāhmaṇa humbly replied:

তোমারে ‘ভিক্ষা’ দিব, বড় ভাগ্য সে আমার ।
তুমি — ঈশ্বর, নাহি তোমার বিধি-ব্যবহার ॥ ১৮২ ॥

tomāre ‘bhikṣā’ diba, baḍa bhāgya se āmāra
to You a meal I shall give great fortune that is my
tumi — īśvara, nāhi tomāra vidhi-vyavahāra
You are the Lord there is not Your rule-bound conduct

182 “To give You a meal is my great good fortune. You are the Lord; You are not bound by rules of conduct.

Anubhāṣya.
In this connection see Madhya 10.136–140.

*The brāhmaṇa's love for Gaura; he censures the followers of *adaiva-varṇāśrama* —*

‘মূর্খ’-লোক করিবেক তোমার নিন্দন ।
সহিতে না পারিমু সেই ‘দুষ্টে’র বচন ॥ ১৮৩ ॥

‘mūrkha’-loka karibeka tomāra nindana
foolish people will make Your censure
sahite nā pārimu sei ‘duṣṭe’ra vacana
to bear not I shall be able of those wicked men the words

183 But foolish people will censure You, and I will not be able to bear the words of those wicked people.”

Anubhāṣya.
By his family, by birth, that brāhmaṇa, a pure devotee, did not belong to those from whose hands water may be accepted. But he was established in truth and in the *daiva-varṇāśrama* favorable to *bhakti*. Therefore he fearlessly, without hesitation, called “fools” and “wicked” the followers of *adaiva-varṇāśrama*—those who oppose Mahāprabhu and pure *bhakti*, who see caste in a Vaiṣṇava and quibble about *mahā-prasāda*. Here he makes no attempt, under the cover of humility, to lick the feet of the prevailing *smārta* society, hostile to Viṣṇu.

*A description of the various paths of those who follow the religion of the mind (*manodharmī*) —*

প্রভু কহে, — শ্রুতি, স্মৃতি, যত ঋষিগণ ।
সবে ‘এক’-মত নহে, ভিন্ন ভিন্ন ধর্ম্ম ॥ ১৮৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — śruti, smṛti, yata ṛṣi-gaṇa
the Lord says śruti smṛti all the sages
sabe ‘eka’-mata nahe, bhinna bhinna dharma
all of one opinion are not different different dharmas

184 The Lord said, “The śruti, the smṛti and all the sages are not of one opinion; they teach many different kinds of dharma.

Anubhāṣya.

“One opinion”: only the true *dharma* established on the plane of nondual knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*) is “eternal,” “everlasting” (*sanātana*) and one. In it the goal (*upeya*), or *sādhya*, is one, and so too the means (*upāya*), or *sādhana*, the path (*panthā*), is one, not different from the goal. “Various *dharmas*”: the particular properties of the body and mind of each *jīva*, differing from one *jīva* to another; they are rooted in external vision rather than in the vision of one's self (*ātma-darśana*).

The saintly act for the good of the people; therefore only the path Mādhavendra showed carries certain meaning, that is, bestows real truth —

ধর্ম্ম-স্থাপন-হেতু সাধুর ব্যবহার ।
পুরী-গোসাঞির যে আচরণ, সেই ধর্ম্ম সার ॥ ১৮৫ ॥

dharma-sthāpana-hetu sādhura vyavahāra
of dharma establishing for the sake of of the sādhu the conduct
purī-gosāñira ye ācaraṇa, sei dharma sāra
of Purī Gosāñi which conduct that of dharma the essence

185 The conduct of a sādhu is what establishes dharma, and the conduct of Purī Gosāñi is the essence of dharma.

Anubhāṣya.

Sādhu, or *mahājana*: a great person is called a *mahājana*. Spiritual and worldly thinking hold different notions of what is “great.” The conditioned *jīva* judges by the religion of the mind (*manodharma*), that is, by knowledge born of the senses, and so he regards as *mahājanas* those who supply him with objects of enjoyment and fuel for gratifying his senses. For a businessman a *mahājana* may be his “creditor” (*uttamarṇa*); for a *karmī* bent on enjoyment, “the sage Jaimini and others,” or the authors of the *dharma-śāstras* who uphold various opinions; for those who wish to restrain the mind, “the sage Patañjali and others”; for those who walk the path of dry knowledge, the *kevalādvaita-vādīs*—the godless Kapila, Vasiṣṭha, Durvāsā, Dattātreya and the rest. For those under *rajas* and *tamas*, the *mahājanas* are kings proud of brute strength and matchless in their persistence in opposing Viṣṇu—Hiraṇyākṣa, Hiraṇyakaśipu, Rāvaṇa and his son Meghanāda, Jarāsandha and others—and devotees of their *gurus* such as Ekalavya and Karṇa. For those who think themselves men and love the company of women, the *mahājanas* are the *prajāpatis* headed by Dakṣa, who worshiped women. Worldly people may choose as *mahājanas* those who wish or strive to rid them of bodily and mental disease, grief, suffering, fear or petty wants. A *jīva* bewitched by *prakṛti* may decide that his *mahājanas* are “philosophers,” “scientists,” “historians,” “men of letters,” “poets,” “orators,” “leaders of society” or “leaders of the nation” who have no connection with Viṣṇu. For the self-deceived, the *mahājanas* are cheats and greedy hirelings. They believe that devotion to Bhagavān, the highest goal and the very nature of the soul, is bound by semen and blood; that is, appealing only to their family by birth, they lay claim to devotion to Bhagavān, the mother of self-knowledge, or to the position of *guru*. Others may count as *mahājanas* the opponents of a true *sādhu* like Śrī Haridāsa—such as the “hypocrite brāhmaṇa” (*ḍhaṅga-vipra*)[11]—and those who artificially, outwardly imitate his transcendental service to Hari; experts in tricks and sorcery; *asuras* such as Pūtanā, Tṛṇāvarta, Vatsa, Baka, Agha, Dhenuka, Kālīya and Pralamba; or the enemies of Viṣṇu—Pauṇḍraka, Śṛgāla-vāsudeva, Śukra the *guru* of the Daityas, the atheist Cārvāka, Veṇa, Sugata, Arhat and the rest. So too the cheats who do not believe that Gaura-Kṛṣṇa is the real Truth and the Supreme Lord imitate Him: they proclaim themselves *avatāras*, or else, using charming words that suit the anti-Viṣṇu *manodharma* of the deceived, they want the deceived to proclaim them *avatāras*. Foolish, deceived, unfortunate people may imagine them to be *mahājanas*. In short, for those without devotion to Bhagavān, such people—“*anyābhilāṣīs*” (those with other desires), “*karmīs*,”

“dry *jñānīs*,” “yogīs without *bhakti*,” or those greedy for gold, women and fame—may indeed be called “*mahājanas*.” But the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, free of envy and of all deceit, which establishes the Supreme Truth, the real substance, says (6.3.25): “As a rule, even these *mahājanas* do not know this [the glory of *bhakti*], for the divine *māyā* has thoroughly bewildered their minds. Their minds are dulled by the flowery, honeyed words of the three Vedas, and they are engaged in great sacrificial rites.” That is, the *karmīs* famed in the world as “*mahājanas*,” these preachers of *dharma*, do not know the glory of devotion to Bhagavān. Their intelligence is bewildered by Viṣṇu's *māyā*, made of the three modes; so they disregard devotion to Bhagavān, which belongs to Vaikuṇṭha, busy themselves with the sprawling *karma-kāṇḍa* founded on the worship of *prakṛti*, and are caught in the net of *māyā*. The minds of these *mahājanas* are dulled by the sweet, superficially charming eulogies (*arthavāda*) of the Ṛg, Sāma and Yajur Vedas. Although worldly people take them to be “*mahājanas*,” they have no intelligence directed to the eternal service of Puruṣottama, Śrī Bhagavān.

People of this world may be known as “heroes of action” (*karma-vīras*), honored as “heroes of *dharma*,” renowned as “heroes of knowledge,” revered as “models of detachment and renunciation.” But the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* says (3.23.56): “One whose work here does not lead to *dharma*, whose *dharma* does not lead to detachment, and whose detachment does not lead to service to the feet of Him whose feet are a holy place, is dead though alive.” That is, in this world the “hero of action” who does not act for the sake of *dharma*, the “hero of *dharma*” who does not follow *dharma* for the sake of detachment, and the “hero of renunciation” who does not give up enjoyment “for Śrī Viṣṇu's pleasure” is “dead while living.” In truth, “service” is the name for pleasing Hari. And work, *dharma* or renunciation that has no love for Śrī Kṛṣṇa and no connection with Him is in reality only “sense gratification,” or “enjoyment.” Such is service to the nation, service to the public, service to society, service to the *adaiva-varṇāśrama* of birth-lineage (*śaukra*) or caste, service to the sick, the poor, the destitute, the rich, service to women, service to various gods and the like, even though the world proclaims them “the finest virtues” or “deeds worthy of remembrance at dawn.” The unfortunate *jīvas* of this world regard as famous “*mahājanas*” those who supply fuel for such sense gratification—the speakers, preachers or authors of scriptures who foster it.

The *jīva* whose intelligence rests on *prakṛti* sees only the external world; he is a slave of the senses, stricken with the disease of worldly existence. With his distorted intelligence he cannot understand or recognize a real *mahājana*, for his intelligence is always corrupted by the four defects, error (*bhrama*) and the rest.

Since beginningless time, people who see themselves in a corpse made of seven elements—blood, flesh, semen and the rest—and take pleasure in it have drifted, like a flock of sheep, in the stream of knowledge born of the senses. Some of them, of the *prākṛta-sahajiyā* community, disregard even the words of a *mahājana* like Śrī Mādhavendra Purīpāda, pile up offenses at the *mahājana's* feet, call him "narrow-minded" and so on, and so bring trouble on themselves. Others create imaginary *mahājanas* according to their own notions, founded on sense gratification, and plunge into countless offensive deeds: debauchery, lechery, the pursuit of gain, honor and fame, intrigue, violence to living beings and the like.

In truth, until the real "*mahājana*" is identified, none of the *jīva's* efforts can bear good fruit. On what a *mahājana* is, Madhya 25.54–57 says: "No one accepts the Lord as the supreme cause. Each establishes his own view by refuting the views of others. Therefore we do not learn the truth from the six philosophies; what the *mahājana* says, that we accept as truth. The words of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are a stream of nectar; whatever He declares to be reality, that is the essence of truth" (Madhya 25.54, 55, 57)[12]. That is, none of the authors of the *darśanas*—Sāṅkhya, Pātañjala and the rest—truly accepts Viṣṇu as "Īśvara." In a word, they are all "covert" or "overt" atheists; that is, none of them is an *āstika*. They merely tried, by argument, to refute the views of others and to establish their own, so as to show off the prowess of their doctrines. Therefore, although the teachers of these scriptures are known in the world as "*mahājanas*," in fact they are not "*mahājanas*" at all; they themselves are the most "narrow" and "narrow-minded."

Hearing this, the followers of these so-called *mahājanas*, with their mundane knowledge born of the senses, will offend the feet of Śrī Mahāprabhu and of the pure devotee and say, "This is mere 'bigotry'!" In their view, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu and Śrī Mādhavendra Purīpāda too are just more *mahājanas* among those named above! Sunk in the stream of thought of the *prākṛta-sahaja-dharma* and turned into advocates of blending spirit and matter, they will of course arrive at just such a conclusion—what doubt or wonder is there in that? But those in whom the transcendental inherent nature (*svarūpa-dharma*) has awakened are illumined by

its light and can see the *svarūpa* of every *jīva*. Only the *mahā-bhāgavata*, or *paramahaṁsa*, sees Adhokṣaja, and this is true vision (*sudarśana*); therefore these *niṣkiñcanas* alone are the only real "*mahājanas*." Śrīla Mādhavendra Purī Gosvāmī too is a *niṣkiñcana mahājana*: there is no envy or deception of people in his conduct. By his conduct he preached the *daiva-varṇāśrama-dharma*; if one follows it, seeing it as the model, the *jīva* who seeks the highest good (*niḥśreyasa*) will surely attain it. Mahāprabhu taught this by showing the model of *daiva-varṇāśrama-dharma*.

The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (6.3.19–21) names the "twelve" *mahājanas*. In the age of Kali the "*mahājanas*" are the four *ācāryas* of the *sampradāyas* of pure Vaiṣṇavas, who preach devotion to Bhagavān. In our *sampradāya* the original "*mahājana*" is the lord of the Gauḍīyas, Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa. Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana, the dearest associates of the Supreme Truth, Śrī Gaurasundara, whose form is nondifferent from him, and the *sādhus* who follow Śrī Rūpa—all are "*mahājanas*." Śrīdhara Svāmī, a follower of Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī and a *śuddhādvaita-vādī*, is also a "*mahājana*." Caṇḍīdāsa, Vidyāpati and Jayadeva are all "*mahājanas*." But those who see these *mahājanas* as objects of enjoyment—who, instead of "serving" them, rush to measure them as tools for their own petty ends, or to "play *guru* over the *guru*"—those unfortunate people stand very far from these *mahājanas*. Sense gratification, or servitude to *māyā*, comes to them in the guise of an "imaginary *mahājana*"; it deceives them, hides the real path of truth from their senses and leads them astray. Therefore the endeavors of a pure devotee of Bhagavān never become the object of their mundane understanding.

*Only the path of the pure devotee is to be followed — (*Mahābhārata*, Vana-parva, Āraṇeya-parva, ch. 313, verse 117)*

তর্কোঽপ্রতিষ্ঠঃ শ্রুতয়ো বিভিন্না
নাসাবৃষির্যস্য মতং ন ভিন্নম্ ।
ধর্ম্মস্য তত্ত্বং নিহিতং গুহায়াং
মহাজনো যেন গতঃ স পন্থাঃ ॥ ১৮৬ ॥

tarko 'pratiṣṭhaḥ śrutayo vibhinnā
argument is unsettled the śrutis are various
nāsāv ṛṣir yasya mataṁ na bhinnam
there is no such sage whose opinion not differs
dharmasya tattvaṁ nihitaṁ guhāyāṁ
of dharma the truth is hidden in a cave
mahājano yena gataḥ sa panthāḥ
the great soul by which has gone that is the path

186 "Argument is inconclusive, the śrutis differ from one another, and there is no sage whose opinion does not differ from the others. The truth of dharma is hidden in the cave of the heart; the path is the one by which the great souls have gone." (Mahābhārata, Vana-parva, 313.117)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Argument by its very nature has no firm ground; the *śrutis* too differ; and one whose opinion does not differ [from others] cannot be a sage. Therefore the truth of *dharma* lies deeply hidden; that is, it is hard to grasp the truth of *dharma* by reading the scriptures. So all other people should walk the path that he whom the *sādhus* have recognized as a "*mahājana*" has called "the path of the scriptures."

Anubhāṣya.

(The variant reading *vedā vibhinnāḥ smṛtayo vibhinnāḥ*, "the Vedas differ, the *smṛtis* differ," is also found.) **tarkaḥ apratiṣṭhaḥ** (unsteady, not firm), **śrutayaḥ api** (*vibhinnāḥ*: differ, for they show contradictions in addressing people of different qualification); **asau ṛṣiḥ na** (cannot be called a sage), **yasya mataṁ** (conclusion) **bhinnaṁ na** (was not); (in such an age, ruled by argument) **dharmasya** (of the eternal *dharma* of the *jīva*) **tattvaṁ guhāyāṁ** (in the cave of the heart of the *sampradāya* of pure *sādhus* alone, hidden from the eyes of ordinary people) **nihitam** (is concealed, hidden; therefore) **yena** (by which good path) **mahājanaḥ** (a *sādhu* of earlier times, a servant of Adhokṣaja Acyuta) **gataḥ** (has gone), **saḥ** (that alone) **panthāḥ** (is the pure path).

The Lord takes His meal in the brāhmaṇa's house —

তবে সেই বিপ্র প্রভুকে ভিক্ষা করাইল ।
মধুপুরীর লোক-সব প্রভুকে দেখিতে আইল ॥ ১৮৭ ॥

tabe sei vipra prabhuke bhikṣā karāila
then that brāhmaṇa the Lord a meal had Him take
madhu-purīra loka-saba prabhuke dekhite āila
of Madhupurī all the people the Lord to see came

187 Then the brāhmaṇa served the Lord His meal, and all the people of Madhupurī (Mathurā) came to see the Lord.

*Countless people have *darśana* of the Lord —*

লক্ষ-সংখ্য লোক আইসে, নাহিক গণন ।
বাহির হঞা প্রভু দিল দরশন ॥ ১৮৮ ॥

lakṣa-saṅkhya loka āise, nāhika gaṇana
by the hundred thousand people come there is no counting
bāhira hañā prabhu dila daraśana
outside coming the Lord gave His sight

188 People came by the hundreds of thousands, beyond counting, and the Lord came out of the house and showed Himself to them.

*At the Lord's *kīrtana* everyone dances —*

বাহু তুলি' বলে প্রভু 'হরিবোল'-ধ্বনি ।
প্রেমে মত্ত নাচে লোক করি' হরিধ্বনি ॥ ১৮৯ ॥

bāhu tuli' bale prabhu 'hari-bola'-dhvani
arms raising utters the Lord "Haribol" the sound
preme matta nāce loka kari' hari-dhvani
with love maddened dance the people making the sound of Hari

189 Raising His arms, the Lord called out, "Haribol!" and the people danced, mad with love, calling out the name of Hari.

*After bathing at the twenty-four *ghāṭas* of the Yamunā, the Lord sees the holy places the brāhmaṇa shows Him —*

যমুনার ‘চব্বিশ ঘাটে’ প্রভু কৈল স্নান ।
সেই বিপ্র প্রভুকে দেখায় তীর্থস্থান ॥ ১৯০ ॥

yamunāra ‘cabbiśa ghāṭe’ prabhu kaila snāna
of the Yamunā at the twenty-four ghāṭs the Lord took bath
sei vipra prabhuke dekhāya tīrtha-sthāna
that brāhmaṇa to the Lord shows the holy places

190 The Lord bathed at the twenty-four ghāṭs of the Yamunā, and the brāhmaṇa showed Him the holy places.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The twenty-four *ghāṭas* of the Yamunā: (1) Avimukta, (2) Adhirūḍha, (3) Guhya-tīrtha, (4) Prayāga-tīrtha, (5) Kanakhala-tīrtha, (6) Tinduka, (7) Sūrya-tīrtha, (8) Vaṭasvāmī, (9) Dhruva-ghāṭa, (10) Ṛṣi-tīrtha, (11) Mokṣa-tīrtha, (12) Bodha-tīrtha, (13) Gokarṇa, (14) Kṛṣṇa-gaṅgā, (15) Vaikuṇṭha, (16) Asi-kuṇḍa, (17) the Catuḥ-sāmudrika well, (18) Akrūra-tīrtha, (19) the place of the sacrificing brāhmaṇas, (20) Kubjā's well, (21) Raṅga-sthala, (22) Mañca-sthala, (23) the place of the wrestling match and (24) Daśāśvamedha.

স্বয়ম্ভু, বিশ্রাম, দীর্ঘবিষ্ণু, ভূতেশ্বর ।
মহাবিদ্যা, গোকর্ণাদি দেখিলা, বিস্তর ॥ ১৯১ ॥

svayambhu, viśrāma, dīrgha-viṣṇu, bhūteśvara
Svayambhu Viśrāma Dīrgha-viṣṇu Bhūteśvara
mahāvidyā, gokarṇādi dekhilā, vistara
Mahāvidyā Gokarṇa and others He saw in great number

191 He saw Svayambhu, Viśrāma, Dīrgha-viṣṇu, Bhūteśvara, Mahāvidyā, Gokarṇa and many other places.

With that brāhmaṇa the Lord visits the twelve forests —

‘বন’ দেখিবারে যদি প্রভুর মন হৈল ।
সেইত ব্রাহ্মণে প্রভু সঙ্গেতে লইল ॥ ১৯২ ॥

‘vana’ dekhibāre yadi prabhura mana haila
the forests to see when the Lord’s mind was
seita brāhmaṇe prabhu saṅgete laila
that very brāhmaṇa the Lord with Him took

192 When the Lord wished to see the forests, He took that same brāhmaṇa with Him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The forests: the twelve forests. East of Śrī Yamunā there are five: Bhadravana, Bilvavana, Lohavana, Bhāṇḍīravana and Mahāvana. West of the Yamunā there are seven: Madhuvana, Tālavana, Kumudavana, Bahulāvana, Kāmavana, Khadiravana and Vṛndāvana.

মধুবন, তাল, কুমুদ, বহুলা-বন গেলা ।
তাঁহা তাঁহা স্নান করি’ প্রেমাবিষ্ট হৈলা ॥ ১৯৩ ॥

madhu-vana, tāla, kumuda, bahulā-vana gelā
Madhuvana Tāla Kumuda Bahulā-vana He went to
tāṁhā tāṁhā snāna kari’ premāviṣṭa hailā
there there bathing doing absorbed in love He became

193 He went to Madhuvana, Tālavana, Kumudavana and Bahulāvana, bathing in each place and becoming overwhelmed with love.

*The sight of the herd of cows awakens the memory of the pastimes of Vraja and overwhelms the Lord with *prema* —*

পথে গাভীঘটা চরে প্রভুরে দেখিয়া ।
প্রভুকে বেড়য় আসি’ হুঙ্কার করিয়া ॥ ১৯৪ ॥

pathe gābhī-ghaṭā care prabhure dekhiyā
on the way a herd of cows grazing the Lord seeing
prabhuke beḍaya āsi’ huṅkāra kariyā
the Lord surround coming lowing making

194 On the way, a herd of grazing cows saw the Lord, came up lowing loudly and surrounded Him.

গাভী দেখি' স্তব্ধ প্রভু প্রেমের তরঙ্গে ।
বাৎসল্যে গাভী প্রভুর চাটে সব-অঙ্গে ॥ ১৯৫ ॥

gābhī dekhi' stabdha prabhu premera taraṅge
the cows seeing stunned the Lord of love in the waves
vātsalye gābhī prabhura cāṭe saba-aṅge
with motherly affection the cows the Lord's lick whole body

195 At the sight of the cows the Lord stood stunned in waves of love, and with motherly affection the cows licked His whole body.

সুস্থ হঞা প্রভু করে অঙ্গ-কণ্ডূয়ন ।
প্রভু-সঙ্গে চলে, নাহি ছাড়ে ধেনুগণ ॥ ১৯৬ ॥

sustha hañā prabhu kare aṅga-kaṇḍūyana
composed becoming the Lord does scratching of the bodies
prabhu-saṅge cale, nāhi chāḍe dhenu-gaṇa
with the Lord go not leave the cows

196 Coming to Himself, the Lord stroked the cows, and they walked along with Him and would not leave Him.

কষ্টে-সৃষ্ট্যে ধেনু সব রাখিল গোয়াল ।
প্রভুকণ্ঠধ্বনি শুনি' আইসে মৃগীপাল ॥ ১৯৭ ॥

kaṣṭe-sṛṣṭye dhenu saba rākhila goyāla
with difficulty with great effort the cows all held back the cowherd
prabhu-kaṇṭha-dhvani śuni' āise mṛgī-pāla
the sound of the Lord's voice hearing come herds of does

197 With great difficulty the cowherd held all the cows back. Then herds of does, hearing the sound of the Lord's voice, came to Him.

A pair of deer rejoice to see the Lord —

মৃগ-মৃগী মুখ দেখি' প্রভু-অঙ্গ চাটে ।
ভয় নাহি করে, সঙ্গে যায় বাটে-বাটে ॥ ১৯৮ ॥

mṛga-mṛgī mukha dekhi' prabhu-aṅga cāṭe
the bucks and does His face seeing the Lord's body lick
bhaya nāhi kare, saṅge yāya vāṭe-vāṭe
fear not feel with Him go along the paths

198 Looking at His face, the bucks and does licked the Lord's body. Without any fear they followed Him along the paths.

Seeing the Lord, the birds sing sweetly and rejoice —

শুক, পিক, ভৃঙ্গ প্রভুরে দেখি' 'পঞ্চম' গায় ।
শিখিগণ নৃত্য করি' প্রভু-আগে যায় ॥ ১৯৯ ॥

śuka, pika, bhṛṅga prabhure dekhi' 'pañcama' gāya
parrots cuckoos bees the Lord seeing in the fifth note sing
śikhi-gaṇa nṛtya kari' prabhu-āge yāya
the peacocks dancing doing before the Lord go

199 Seeing the Lord, the parrots, cuckoos and bees sang in the fifth note (*pañcama*), and the peacocks went dancing before Him.

Even the trees and creepers thrill with joy and shed tears —

প্রভু দেখি' বৃন্দাবনের বৃক্ষ-লতাগণে ।
অঙ্কুর-পুলক, মধু-অশ্রু বরিষণে ॥ ২০০ ॥

prabhu dekhi' vṛndāvanera vṛkṣa-latā-gaṇe
the Lord seeing of Vṛndāvana the trees and creepers
aṅkura-pulaka, madhu-aśru variṣaṇe
sprouts as hair standing on end honey as tears shower

200 At the sight of the Lord, the trees and creepers of Vṛndāvana put forth sprouts like hair standing on end in ecstasy, and they rained honey like tears.

ফুল-ফল ভরি' ডাল পড়ে প্রভু-পায় ।
বন্ধু দেখি' বন্ধু যেন 'ভেট' লঞা যায় ॥ ২০১ ॥

phula-phala bhari' ḍāla paḍe prabhu-pāya
with flowers and fruits laden branches fall at the Lord's feet
bandhu dekhi' bandhu yena 'bheṭa' lañā yāya
a friend seeing a friend as if a gift taking goes

201 Their branches, laden with flowers and fruits, bent down to the Lord's feet, as a friend comes with a gift on seeing a friend.

Seeing the Lord, all beings, moving and unmoving, rejoice and play with the Lord —

প্রভু দেখি' বৃন্দাবনের স্থাবর-জঙ্গম ।
আনন্দিত, বন্ধু যেন দেখে বন্ধুগণ ॥ ২০২ ॥

prabhu dekhi' vṛndāvanera sthāvara-jaṅgama
the Lord seeing of Vṛndāvana the unmoving and moving beings
ānandita, bandhu yena dekhe bandhu-gaṇa
are joyful a friend as if sees friends

202 All the moving and unmoving beings of Vṛndāvana rejoiced to see the Lord, as a friend rejoices on seeing his friends.

তা-সবার প্রীতি দেখি' প্রভু ভাবাবেশে ।
সবা-সনে ক্রীড়া করে হঞা তার বশে ॥ ২০৩ ॥

tā-sabāra prīti dekhi' prabhu bhāvāveśe
of them all the love seeing the Lord in rapture
sabā-sane krīḍā kare hañā tāra vaśe
with all play does becoming their subject to

203 Witnessing their affection, the Lord, rapt in ecstasy, played with them all and gave Himself into their power.

প্রতি বৃক্ষ-লতা প্রভু করেন আলিঙ্গন ।
পুষ্পাদি ধ্যানে করেন কৃষ্ণে সমর্পণ ॥ ২০৪ ॥

prati vṛkṣa-latā prabhu karena āliṅgana
every tree and creeper the Lord makes embrace
puṣpādi dhyāne karena kṛṣṇe samarpaṇa
flowers and the rest in meditation He makes to Kṛṣṇa offering

204 The Lord embraced every tree and creeper, and in meditation He offered their flowers and other gifts to Kṛṣṇa.

*The Lord, maddened by *kṛṣṇa-prema* —*

অশ্রু-কম্প-পুলক-প্রেমে শরীর অস্থিরে ।
‘কৃষ্ণ’ বল, ‘কৃষ্ণ’ বল, বলে উচ্চৈঃস্বরে ॥ ২০৫ ॥

aśru-kampa-pulaka-preme śarīra asthire
tears trembling thrills from love His body restless
‘kṛṣṇa’ bala, ‘kṛṣṇa’ bala, bale uccaiḥsvare
Kṛṣṇa say Kṛṣṇa say He says in a loud voice

205 His body was restless with the tears, trembling and thrills of love, and He called out in a loud voice, “Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’! Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’!”

When the Lord chants Kṛṣṇa's name, all echo “Kṛṣṇa!” —

স্থাবর-জঙ্গম মিলি’ করে কৃষ্ণধ্বনি ।
প্রভুর গম্ভীর-স্বরে যেন প্রতিধ্বনি ॥ ২০৬ ॥

sthāvara-jaṅgama mili’ kare kṛṣṇa-dhvani
the unmoving and moving beings together make the sound of Kṛṣṇa
prabhura gambhīra-svare yena prati-dhvani
to the Lord’s deep voice as if an echo

206 All the moving and unmoving beings together cried out “Kṛṣṇa!”, as if echoing the Lord’s deep voice.

*The Lord weeps with *prema*, embracing a deer —*

মৃগের গলা ধরি’ প্রভু করেন রোদনে ।
মৃগের পুলক অঙ্গে, অশ্রু নয়নে ॥ ২০৭ ॥

mṛgera galā dhari' prabhu karena rodane
of a deer the neck embracing the Lord makes weeping
mṛgera pulaka aṅge, aśru nayane
the deer's thrill on the body tears in the eyes

207 Embracing a deer around the neck, the Lord wept, and the deer's body thrilled, and tears filled its eyes.

The Lord listens to the parrots sing, the male taking Kṛṣṇa's side, the female Rādhā's —

বৃক্ষডালে শুক-শারী দিল দরশন ।
তাহা দেখি' প্রভুর কিছু শুনিতে হৈল মন ॥ ২০৮ ॥

vṛkṣa-ḍāle śuka-śārī dila daraśana
on the branch of a tree a male and a female parrot gave sight of themselves
tāhā dekhi' prabhura kichu śunite haila mana
that seeing in the Lord something to hear arose a wish

208 On the branch of a tree a male and a female parrot appeared, and seeing them, the Lord wished to hear them say something.

শুক-শারিকা প্রভুর হাতে উড়ি' পড়ে ।
প্রভুকে শুনাঞা কৃষ্ণের গুণ-শ্লোক পড়ে ॥ ২০৯ ॥

śuka-śārikā prabhura hāte uḍi' paḍe
the male and female parrots the Lord's onto the hand flying alight
prabhuke śunāñā kṛṣṇera guṇa-śloka paḍe
for the Lord to hear Kṛṣṇa's of qualities a verse recite

209 The parrots flew down onto the Lord's hand, and began to recite verses on Kṛṣṇa's qualities for the Lord to hear.

*The male parrot sings Kṛṣṇa's qualities — (*Govinda-līlāmṛta*, canto 13,*

verse 29: the male parrot's words to the female)

সৌন্দর্য্যং ললনালিধৈর্য্যদলনং লীলা রমাস্তম্ভিনী
বীর্য্যং কন্দুকিতাদ্রিবর্য্যমমলাঃ পারে পরার্দ্ধং গুণাঃ ৷
শীলং সর্ব্বজনানুরঞ্জনমহো যস্যায়মস্মৎপ্রভু-
র্বিশ্বং বিশ্বজনীনকীর্ত্তিরবতাৎ কৃষ্ণো জগন্মোহনঃ ॥ ২১০ ॥

saundaryaṁ lalanāli-dhairya-dalanaṁ līlā ramā-stambhinī
beauty of the rows of young women the composure crushing pastimes Ramā astonishing

vīryaṁ kandukitādri-varyam amalāḥ pāre parārdhaṁ guṇāḥ
prowess turning into a ball the mountain best spotless beyond a parārdha qualities

śīlaṁ sarva-janānurañjanam aho yasyāyam asmat-prabhur
character all people delighting aho whose this our Lord

viśvaṁ viśva-janīna-kīrtir avatāt kṛṣṇo jagan-mohanaḥ
the universe for all the world beneficial whose fame may protect Kṛṣṇa the enchanter of the world

210 (The male parrot recited:) “His beauty shatters the composure of the young women; His pastimes astonish Ramā (Lakṣmī); His strength turns the best of mountains into a ball; His spotless qualities are beyond all counting; His character delights all people. Ah, may our Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enchanter of the world, whose fame is a blessing for the whole world, protect the universe!” (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 13.29)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Śuka said: “His beauty steals the composure of women; His pastimes stun the goddess Lakṣmī; His prowess turns Govardhana Hill into a plaything like a ball. His pure qualities lie beyond a *parārdha*; His character delights all people. May my Lord, Kṛṣṇa, the enchanter of the world, whose fame is for the good of the whole world, protect the universe.”

Anubhāṣya.

yasya (Kṛṣṇa's) **saundaryaṁ** (enchanting form) **lalanāli-dhairya-dalanaṁ** (whose nature is to shatter the composure of all beautiful women, the girls of Vraja), **yasya līlā** (play full of spiritual sport) **ramā-stambhinī** (whose nature is to

stun and stir Ramā), **yasya vīryaṁ** (prowess) **kandukitādri-varyam** (by which the best of mountains, Govardhana, the king of mountains, was made a ball), **yasya pāre-parārdhaṁ** (gone beyond the limit of a *parārdha*, that is, immeasurable) **amalāḥ** (faultless) **guṇāḥ**, **aho yasya śīlaṁ** (character) **sarva-janānurañjanam** (delighting all people, the devotees), **saḥ ayam asmat-prabhuḥ** (the sole refuge of servants like me) **viśva-janīna-kīrtiḥ** (whose fame is for the good of all people) **jagan-mohanaḥ** (the most beautiful in the world) **kṛṣṇaḥ viśvam avatāt** (may He protect).

শুক-মুখে শুনি' তবে কৃষ্ণের বর্ণন ।
শারিকা পড়য়ে তবে রাধিকা-বর্ণন ॥ ২১১ ॥

śuka-mukhe śuni' tabe kṛṣṇera varṇana
from the parrot's mouth hearing then of Kṛṣṇa the description
śārikā paḍaye tabe rādhikā-varṇana
the female parrot recites then of Rādhikā a description

211 When she had heard the male parrot describe Kṛṣṇa, the female parrot recited a description of Rādhikā:

*The female parrot sings Rādhikā's qualities — (*Govinda-līlāmṛta*, canto 13, verse 30: the female parrot's words to the male)*

শ্রীরাধিকায়াঃ প্রিয়তা স্বরূপতা
সুশীলতা নর্ত্তনগানচাতুরী ।
গুণালিসম্পৎ কবিতা চ রাজতে
জগন্মনোমোহন-চিত্তমোহিনী ॥ ২১২ ॥

śrī-rādhikāyāḥ priyatā svarūpatā
of Śrī Rādhikā the affection the beauty of Her own form
su-śīlatā nartana-gāna-cāturī
the good character in dancing singing the skill
guṇāli-sampat kavitā ca rājate
of hosts of qualities the wealth poetry and shine
jagan-mano-mohana-citta-mohinī
of the world's minds of the enchanter the heart enchanting

212 “Śrī Rādhikā’s affection, the beauty of Her own form, Her good character, Her skill in dancing and singing, Her wealth of qualities and Her poetry shine forth; they enchant the heart of Him who enchants the minds of the whole world.” (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 13.30)[7]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śārī said: “The love, beauty, good conduct, skill in dancing and singing, poetic gift and other qualities of Śrīmatī Rādhikā shine, enchanting the heart of Kṛṣṇa, who enchants the mind of the world.”

Anubhāṣya.

śrī-rādhikāyāḥ priyatā (love), **svarūpatā**[13] (extraordinary beauty; or the form of *mahābhāva*, that by which Her own self is revealed [*nirūpyate*]), **su-śīlatā** (fine character, good conduct), **nartana-gāna-cāturī** (skill, expertise or refinement in dancing and singing), **guṇāli-sampat** (Her wealth, a succession of qualities), **kavitā** (poetic gift)—**ca** all of these, **jagan-mano-mohana-citta-mohinī** (enchanting, that is, delighting, the mind of Kṛṣṇa, who enchants the mind of the world), **rājate** (shine).

পুনঃ শুক কহে, — কৃষ্ণ ‘মদনমোহন’ ।
তবে আর শ্লোক শুক করিল পঠন ॥ ২১৩ ॥

punaḥ śuka kahe, — kṛṣṇa ‘madana-mohana’
again the parrot says Kṛṣṇa is Madana-mohana
tabe āra śloka śuka karila paṭhana
then another verse the parrot made recitation

213 Again the male parrot said, “Kṛṣṇa is Madana-mohana, the enchanter of Cupid,” and recited another verse:

*The male parrot's song: Kṛṣṇa is “Madana-mohana” — (*Govinda-līlāmṛta*, canto 13, verse 31: the male parrot's words to the female)*

বংশীধারী জগন্নারী-চিত্তহারী স শারিকে ।
বিহারী গোপনারীভির্জীয়ান্মদনমোহনঃ ॥ ২১৪ ॥

vaṁśī-dhārī jagan-nārī-
the holder of the flute of the world's women
citta-hārī sa śārike
the stealer of the hearts He O śārī
vihārī gopa-nārībhir
who sports with the cowherd women
jīyān madana-mohanaḥ
may He be victorious the enchanter of Cupid

214 "O Śārikā, He who holds the flute and steals the hearts of the women of the world, who sports with the cowherd maidens — may that Madana-mohana be victorious!" (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 13.31)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śuka said: "O Śārikā, may Madana-mohana be victorious—He who holds the flute, steals the hearts of the women of the world and sports with the *gopīs*!"

Anubhāṣya.
śārike (O Śārikā), **vaṁśī-dhārī** (the holder of the flute) **jagan-nārī-citta-hārī** (the thief of the hearts of the women of the world, of the fourteen worlds) **gopa-nārībhiḥ** (with the girls of Vraja) **vihārī** (absorbed in sport), **saḥ** (that famous) **madana-mohanaḥ jīyāt** (may He reign supreme over all).

পুনঃ শারী কহে শুকে করি' পরিহাস ।
তাহা শুনি' প্রভুর হৈল বিস্ময়-প্রেমোল্লাস ॥ ২১৫ ॥

punaḥ śārī kahe śuke kari' parihāsa
again the female parrot says to the male making a jest
tāhā śuni' prabhura haila vismaya-premollāsa
that hearing in the Lord arose wonder and the joy of love

215 Then the female parrot spoke to the male parrot in jest, and hearing her, the Lord was filled with wonder and the joy of love:

*The female parrot's song: Kṛṣṇa is Madana-mohana because of Śrī Rādhā — (*Govinda-līlāmṛta*, canto 13, verse 32: the female parrot's words to the*

male)

রাধা-সঙ্গে যদা ভাতি, তদা 'মদনমোহনঃ' ।
অন্যথা বিশ্বমোহোঽপি স্বয়ং 'মদনমোহিতঃ' ॥ ২১৬ ॥

rādhā-saṅge yadā bhāti
with Rādhā when He shines
tadā 'madana-mohanaḥ'
then He is "Madana-mohana"
anyathā viśva-moho 'pi
otherwise the enchanter of the universe though
svayaṁ 'madana-mohitaḥ'
Himself is "madana-mohita"

216 "When He shines with Rādhā, then He is 'Madana-mohana,' the enchanter of Cupid. Otherwise, though He enchants the universe, He Himself is 'madana-mohita,' enchanted by Cupid." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 13.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śārī replied in jest: "Only when Kṛṣṇa shines beside Rādhā is He 'Madana-mohana.' When Śrī Rādhā is not with Him, He, though the enchanter of the universe, is Himself enchanted by Madana."

Anubhāṣya.
(O Śuka,) **yadā** (when) (Kṛṣṇa) **rādhā-saṅge bhāti** (shines), **tadā** (only then is) (Kṛṣṇa) **madana-mohanaḥ**; **anyathā** (otherwise, when Kṛṣṇa is without Rādhā's company, He) **svayam** (Himself) **viśva-mohaḥ** (the enchanter of the world) **api svayaṁ madana-mohitaḥ** (is enchanted by Madana, Kandarpa—by the principle "Searching for Rādhikā here and there, His heart tormented by the wounds of Anaṅga's arrows…"[14]).

Seeing the peacocks, the Lord remembers Kṛṣṇa's form and faints —

শুক-শারী উড়ি' পুনঃ গেল বৃক্ষডালে ।
ময়ূরের নৃত্য প্রভু দেখে কুতূহলে ॥ ২১৭ ॥

śuka-śārī uḍi' punaḥ gela vṛkṣa-ḍāle
the male and female parrots flying up again went to the branch of a tree
mayūrera nṛtya prabhu dekhe kutūhale
of the peacocks the dance the Lord watches with eagerness

217 The parrots flew back up to the branch of the tree, and the Lord eagerly watched the dancing of the peacocks.

ময়ূরের কণ্ঠ দেখি' প্রভুর কৃষ্ণকান্তি-স্মৃতি হৈল ।
প্রেমাবেশে মহাপ্রভু ভূমিতে পড়িল ॥ ২১৮ ॥

mayūrera kaṇṭha dekhi' prabhura kṛṣṇa-kānti-smṛti haila
of the peacocks the necks seeing in the Lord of Kṛṣṇa's luster the remembrance arose
premāveśe mahāprabhu bhūmite paḍila
in the rapture of love Mahāprabhu to the ground fell

218 Seeing the necks of the peacocks, the Lord remembered the lustre of Kṛṣṇa's body, and Mahāprabhu fell to the ground in the rapture of love.

The brāhmaṇa and the Bhaṭṭācārya try to bring the Lord back to consciousness

—

প্রভুরে মূর্চ্ছিত দেখি' সেই ত' ব্রাহ্মণ ।
ভট্টাচার্য্য-সঙ্গে করে প্রভুর সন্তর্পণ ॥ ২১৯ ॥

prabhure mūrcchita dekhi' sei ta' brāhmaṇa
the Lord unconscious seeing that very brāhmaṇa
bhaṭṭācārya-saṅge kare prabhura santarpaṇa
with the Bhaṭṭācārya does the Lord's reviving

219 Seeing the Lord unconscious, the brāhmaṇa and the Bhaṭṭācārya tried to revive Him.

Anubhāṣya.
Santarpaṇa: careful service.

আস্তে-ব্যস্তে মহাপ্রভুর লঞা বহির্ব্বাস ।
জলসেক করে অঙ্গে, বস্ত্রের বাতাস ॥ ২২০ ॥

āste-vyaste mahāprabhura lañā bahirvāsa
hastily hurriedly Mahāprabhu's taking outer cloth
jala-seka kare aṅge, vastrera vātāsa
sprinkling of water they do on the body with the cloth fanning

220 Hurriedly they took Mahāprabhu's outer cloth, sprinkled His body with water and fanned Him with the cloth.

Kṛṣṇa's name is chanted loudly into the Lord's ear; the Lord regains consciousness and rolls on the ground —

প্রভু-কর্ণে কৃষ্ণনাম কহে উচ্চ করি' ।
চেতন পাঞা প্রভু যা'ন গড়াগড়ি ॥ ২২১ ॥

prabhu-karṇe kṛṣṇa-nāma kahe ucca kari'
in the Lord's ear the name of Kṛṣṇa they say loud making it
cetana pāñā prabhu yā'na gaḍāgaḍi
consciousness regaining the Lord goes rolling on the ground

221 They spoke the name of Kṛṣṇa loudly in the Lord's ear, and regaining consciousness, the Lord rolled about on the ground.

Through the Bhaṭṭācārya's care the Lord recovers —

কণ্টক-দুর্গম বনে অঙ্গ ক্ষত হৈল ।
ভট্টাচার্য্য কোলে করি' প্রভুরে সুস্থ কৈল ॥ ২২২ ॥

kaṇṭaka-durgama vane aṅga kṣata haila
with thorns impassable in the forest His body wounded became
bhaṭṭācārya kole kari' prabhure sustha kaila
the Bhaṭṭācārya on his lap taking the Lord calm made

222 In that forest, impassable with thorns, His body was scratched and cut. The Bhaṭṭācārya took the Lord on his lap and calmed Him.

*In the ecstasy of *prema* the Lord calls on all to chant the name of Hari —*

কৃষ্ণাবেশে প্রভুর প্রেমে গরগর মন ।
‘বোল্’ ‘বোল্’ করি’ উঠি’ করেন নর্ত্তন ॥ ২২৩ ॥

kṛṣṇāveśe prabhura preme garagara mana
absorbed in Kṛṣṇa the Lord’s with love overwhelmed mind
‘bol’ ‘bol’ kari’ uṭhi’ karena nartana
say say crying rising He does dancing

223 In His absorption in Kṛṣṇa the Lord’s mind was overwhelmed with love. Crying “Say it! Say it!” He got up and began to dance.

The chanting of Kṛṣṇa's name; the Lord goes on —

ভট্টাচার্য্য, সেই বিপ্র কৃষ্ণনাম গায় ।
নাচিতে নাচিতে পথে প্রভু চলি’ যায় ॥ ২২৪ ॥

bhaṭṭācārya, sei vipra kṛṣṇa-nāma gāya
the Bhaṭṭācārya that brāhmaṇa the name of Kṛṣṇa sing
nācite nācite pathe prabhu cali’ yāya
dancing dancing along the path the Lord goes on

224 The Bhaṭṭācārya and the brāhmaṇa sang the name of Kṛṣṇa, and the Lord went on along the path, dancing all the way.

The brāhmaṇa is amazed and anxious for the Lord —

প্রভুর প্রেমাবেশ দেখি’ ব্রাহ্মণ — বিস্মিত ।
প্রভুর রক্ষা লাগি’ বিপ্র হইলা চিন্তিত ॥ ২২৫ ॥

prabhura premāveśa dekhi’ brāhmaṇa — vismita
of the Lord the rapture of love seeing the brāhmaṇa is amazed
prabhura rakṣā lāgi’ vipra hailā cintita
of the Lord protection for the sake of the brāhmaṇa became anxious

225 The brāhmaṇa was amazed to see the Lord’s rapture of love, and he grew anxious about how to keep the Lord safe.

*On the way from Purī to Vṛndāvana the Lord's *prema* grows stronger —*

নীলাচলে ছিলা যৈছে প্রেমাবেশ মন ।
বৃন্দাবন যাইতে পথে হৈল শত-গুণ ॥ ২২৬ ॥

nīlācale chilā yaiche premāveśa mana
in Nīlācala was as absorbed in love His mind
vṛndāvana yāite pathe haila śata-guṇa
to Vṛndāvana going on the way it became a hundredfold

226 The absorption in love His mind had known in Nīlācala became a hundred times greater on the way to Vṛndāvana.

*At the sight of Mathurā His *prema* is stronger still, and wandering in Vṛndāvana, stronger yet —*

সহস্রগুণ প্রেম বাড়ে মথুরা-দরশনে ।
লক্ষগুণ প্রেম বাড়ে, ভ্রমেন যবে বনে ॥ ২২৭ ॥

sahasra-guṇa prema bāḍe mathurā-daraśane
a thousandfold love increases at the sight of Mathurā
lakṣa-guṇa prema bāḍe, bhramena yabe vane
a hundred-thousandfold love increases He wanders when in the forests

227 At the sight of Mathurā His love increased a thousandfold, and when He wandered in the forests it increased a hundred-thousandfold.

The Lord performs His daily duties out of habit —

অন্য দেশে প্রেম উছলে 'বৃন্দাবন'-নামে ।
সাক্ষাৎ ভ্রময়ে এবে সেই বৃন্দাবনে ॥ ২২৮ ॥

প্রেমে গরগর মন রাত্রি-দিবসে ।
স্নান-ভিক্ষাদি-নির্ব্বাহ করেন অভ্যাসে ॥ ২২৯ ॥

anya deśe prema uchale 'vṛndāvana'-nāme
in other lands love overflows at the name of Vṛndāvana
sākṣāt bhramaye ebe sei vṛndāvane
in person He wanders now in that very Vṛndāvana
preme garagara mana rātri-divase
with love overwhelmed His mind night and day
snāna-bhikṣādi-nirvāha karena abhyāse
bathing eating and the rest carrying out He does by habit

228–229 In other lands His love would overflow at the very name of Vṛndāvana, and now He was wandering in Vṛndāvana itself. His mind was overwhelmed with love night and day; He bathed, ate and did everything else only out of habit.

*This *prema* of the Lord is indescribable —*

এইমত প্রেম, যাবৎ ভ্রমিল 'বার' বন ।
একত্র লিখিলুঁ, সর্ব্বত্র না যায় বর্ণন ॥ ২৩০ ॥

ei-mata prema, yāvat bhramila 'bāra' vana
such love as long as He wandered the twelve forests
ekatra likhiluṁ, sarvatra nā yāya varṇana
in one place I have written everywhere not can be the description

230 Such was His love all the while He wandered through the twelve forests. I have described it in one place; it cannot be described everywhere.

*Even Bhagavān Śeṣa cannot describe the *prema* the Lord showed while wandering in Vṛndāvana —*

বৃন্দাবনে হৈল প্রভুর যতেক প্রেমের বিকার ।
কোটি-গ্রন্থে 'অনন্ত' লিখেন তাহার বিস্তার ॥ ২৩১ ॥

vṛndāvane haila prabhura yateka premera vikāra
in Vṛndāvana there were the Lord's all the of love transformations
koṭi-granthe 'ananta' likhena tāhāra vistāra
in millions of books Ananta writes their details

231 Ananta writes in millions of books about all the transformations of love the Lord showed in Vṛndāvana.

In this chapter only a general indication of it is given —

তবু লিখিবারে নারে তার এক কণ ।
উদ্দেশ করিতে করি দিগ্‌দরশন ॥ ২৩২ ॥

tabu likhibāre nāre tāra eka kaṇa
still to write He cannot of it one particle
uddeśa karite kari dig-daraśana
a pointer to give I make an indication of direction

232 Yet even He cannot describe a particle of them. To give some indication, I only point the way.

Each touches the flood of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's pastimes in the measure of the depth of his love for Kṛṣṇa —

জগৎ ভাসিল চৈতন্যলীলার পাথারে ।
যাঁর যত শক্তি, তত পাথারে সাঁতারে ॥ ২৩৩ ॥

jagat bhāsila caitanya-līlāra pāthāre
the world was flooded of Caitanya's pastimes in the ocean
yāṁra yata śakti, tata pāthāre sāṁtāre
whose as much strength so much in the ocean swims

233 The world was flooded by the ocean of Caitanya's pastimes; everyone swims in that ocean as far as his strength allows.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Pāthāra: a flood, a rising of the waters.

Thus ends the seventeenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the seventeenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ২৩৪ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

234 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Madhya 4.2 (the refrain of Ādi 4.2 with *gauracandra* in the first line); translation as there. ↩
2. *Snigdha*, "full of love": so Śrīdhara Svāmī explains *snigdhasya* in Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.8 — *premavataḥ*, "to one who is full of love" ↩
3. *Paramānanda-mādhava*, "Mādhava, the supreme bliss." ↩
4. The source as in the edition's heading: "a saying of the *Padma Purāṇa* and the *Viṣṇu-dharmottara*". ↩
5. The same verse as Madhya 6.186; translation as there. ↩
6. The same verse as Ādi 3.25; translation as there. ↩
7. The edition reads *svarūpatā* (in the verse and in the gloss of the *Anubhāṣya*); another reading is *su-rūpatā*, "beauty". ↩
8. So in the edition. In sense, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.19.24 is probably meant (one should not live where the rivers of talk about Vaikuṇṭha do not flow). ↩
9. Unclear passage: the edition reads «নিত্য স্বধর্ম্ম করায় কৃষ্ণানুশীলনের…» ("performing the eternal *svadharma*, … of the cultivation of Kṛṣṇa"); «করায়» seems superfluous or a misprint here; translated by sense. ↩
10. So in the edition (checked against the scan). The *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* on verse 149 has Veṇī-mādhava, the Deity of Prayāga; Bindu-mādhava is the Deity of Vārāṇasī. ↩
11. *Ḍhaṅga-vipra* — a hypocrite brāhmaṇa who makes a show of feigned ecstasy. The edition gives no source. ↩
12. The edition refers to Madhya 25.54–57 but quotes verses 54, 55 and 57; verse 56 is the *Mahābhārata* verse that also appears as Madhya 17.186. ↩

13. So in the edition, both in the verse and in the gloss (checked against the scan); Vṛndāvana Candra Dāsa's transliteration has *su-rūpatā*. ↩
14. *Gīta-govinda* 3.2. ↩